

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Carvaka (Cārvāka / Lokāyata) - Learner-v2

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Carvaka (Cārvāka / Lokāyata)

English-first concept spine • Sanskrit/Pali IAST follows in parentheses

- 1 perception (pratyakṣa)
- 2 means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)
- 3 invariable concomitance (vyāpti)
- 4 conscious body as self (dehātmavāda)

Read the complete Markdown/PDF for arguments, objections, PYQs and model answers.

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Carvaka (Cārvāka / Lokāyata) - Learner-v2 Source-Complete Learning Session

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Practice protocol - [CORE ANSWER]

Attempt each item before reading its key. Answer placement is balanced, deterministic and non-patterned using a stable topic seed. across all forty-eight diagnostics.

Questions 1-40 are original diagnostic practice. Answer placement is balanced, deterministic and non-patterned using a stable topic seed.

1. The three names

Which set correctly pairs each name of the school with the sense recorded in the standard textbooks?

- A. *Cārvāka* - from *carv*, "to chew", giving the "eat, drink and be merry" doctrine, or from *cāru-vāk*, "sweet-worded"; *Lokāyata* - *lokāyata-mata*, "the view of the common people"; *Bārhaspatya* - "of Bṛhaspati", the traditional founder whose *Sūtra* is lost.
- B. *Cārvāka* - a Buddhist sect of the *Majjhima Nikāya*; *Lokāyata* - the Jaina name for materialism; *Bārhaspatya* - a Mīmāṃsā sub-school.
- C. *Cārvāka* - "the four-element theorist"; *Lokāyata* - "the world-renouncer"; *Bārhaspatya* - a disciple of Jayarāṣi.
- D. *Cārvāka* - "the sceptic"; *Lokāyata* - "the ritualist"; *Bārhaspatya* - the author of the *Tattvopaplavasīṃha*.

Answer: A. *Cārvāka* - from *carv*, "to chew", giving the "eat, drink and be merry" doctrine, or from *cāru-vāk*, "sweet-worded"; *Lokāyata* - *lokāyata-mata*, "the view of the common people"; *Bārhaspatya* - "of Bṛhaspati", the traditional founder whose *Sūtra* is lost.

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta record both etymologies of "*Cārvāka*" - the name of a sage, or a descriptive name from *carv* ("eat, chew") or *cāru-vāk* ("nice word") - and gloss *lokāyatamata* as "the view of common people". Sharma records Bṛhaspati as "a heretical teacher ... regarded as the traditional founder of this school", whose *Sūtra* "has unfortunately perished". D misattributes the *Tattvopaplavasīṃha*, which is Jayarāṣi's.

MEMORY: Trap: *Lokāyata* means "of the common people", not "world-renouncing" - the school is emphatically **this-worldly**.

2. The exact sense of Veda-rejecting school (nāstika)

In Sanskrit philosophical literature, in what sense or senses is *Cārvāka Veda-rejecting school (nāstika)*?

- A. In neither sense, since *Veda-rejecting school (nāstika)* applies only to schools that deny the external world.
- B. In **both** classical senses - it rejects the authority of the Vedas, which is the primary classificatory criterion, and it denies life after death; Jaina and Bauddha schools, by contrast, are *Veda-rejecting school (nāstika)* on the first criterion but would count as *āstika* on the second.
- C. Only in the modern vernacular sense of "atheist", since it denies God.
- D. Only in the second sense, since *Cārvāka* accepts Vedic authority while rejecting the afterlife.

Answer: B. In both classical senses - it rejects the authority of the Vedas, which is the primary classificatory criterion, and it denies life after death; Jaina and Bauddha schools, by contrast, are Veda-rejecting school (nāstika) on the first criterion but would count as āstika on the second.

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta set this out exactly: "'Āstika' means 'one who believes in the authority of the Vedas' or 'one who believes in life after death'... The six orthodox schools are 'āstika', and the *Cārvāka* is 'Veda-rejecting school (nāstika)' **in both the senses.**" They add that in the second sense "even the Jaina and Bauddha schools are 'āstika', as they believe in life after death." B adopts the modern vernacular sense, which fails

because Sāṃkhya and Mīmāṃsā are non-theistic yet *āstika*. C reverses the school's most famous rejection.

MEMORY: **Trap:** *Veda-rejecting school (nāstika)* is primarily about **Vedic authority**, not about God.

3. The source situation

Which statement best describes the textual situation of Cārvāka philosophy?

- A. Nothing whatever is known of the school, since all sources are hostile.
- B. The complete *Bṛhaspati-sūtra* survives with three commentaries.
- C. No systematic primary work survives; the *Bṛhaspati-sūtra* is lost and only about a dozen *sūtras* and verses are quoted by other authors; knowledge of the school comes chiefly from works that state its views **in order to refute them**, so that, as Sharma puts it, "the weak points ... are exaggerated and the strong points are omitted".
- D. The *Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha* is an independent primary source written by a Cārvāka.

Answer: C. No systematic primary work survives; the *Bṛhaspati-sūtra* is lost and only about a dozen *sūtras* and verses are quoted by other authors; knowledge of the school comes chiefly from works that state its views in order to refute them, so that, as Sharma puts it, "the weak points ... are exaggerated and the strong points are omitted".

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta: "we do not find any systematic work on materialism... almost every work of the other schools states, **for refutation**, the materialistic views. Our knowledge of Indian materialism is chiefly based on these." Sharma adds that even the *Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha* summary "seems to be based on such accounts", which disposes of C. A overstates: convergence across independent hostile sources still fixes a doctrinal core.

MEMORY: **Trap:** the *Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha* is Mādhava's Vedāntic compendium - an opponent's summary, not Cārvāka scripture.

4. Jayarāśi Bhaṭṭa

What is the correct scholarly use of Jayarāśi Bhaṭṭa's *Tattvopaplavasīṃha* in a Cārvāka answer?

- A. As a Nyāya refutation of Cārvāka epistemology.
- B. As a Mīmāṃsā defence of Vedic authority against the materialists.
- C. As the primary text establishing that perception alone is a *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*.
- D. As the sole surviving text-witness of the tradition **and** as its internal limit-case - since Jayarāśi, a Cārvāka "of an extreme type", attacks the validity of **perceptual** knowledge itself and refuses to accept even the physical elements, so he cannot be used to state the school's defining thesis.

Answer: D. As the sole surviving text-witness of the tradition and as its internal limit-case - since Jayarāśi, a Cārvāka "of an extreme type", attacks the validity of perceptual knowledge itself and refuses to accept even the physical elements, so he cannot be used to state the school's defining thesis.

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta describe the *Tattvopaplavasīṃha* as "an interesting specimen of Indian absolute scepticism" whose author "carries the scepticism of the ordinary Cārvāka to its logical conclusion by challenging the validity of perceptual knowledge and refusing to accept the existence of even the physical elements", concluding "like an anti-intellectualist pragmatist" that practical life goes on regardless. Sharma records its publication by the Oriental Institute of Baroda in 1940. D is exactly the misuse the option is designed to test; A and B misplace him entirely.

MEMORY: **Trap:** using Jayarāśi to state Cārvāka epistemology destroys the very thesis - perception alone is a *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)* - that defines the school.

5. The means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa) ledger

Arranged by the number of independent *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas)* admitted, which sequence is correct?

- A. Cārvāka 1 · Vaiśeṣika and Buddhism 2 · Sāṃkhya-Yoga 3 · Nyāya 4 · Prābhākara Mīmāṃsā 5 · Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsā and Advaita 6.

B. Cārvāka 2 · Nyāya 3 · Mīmāṃsā 4 · Advaita 5.

C. Cārvāka 1 · Nyāya 2 · Sāṃkhya 4 · Advaita 3.

D. All schools admit exactly three *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas)*, differing only in their names.

Answer: A. Cārvāka 1 · Vaiśeṣika and Buddhism 2 · Sāṃkhya-Yoga 3 · Nyāya 4 · Prābhākara Mīmāṃsā 5 · Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsā and Advaita 6.

Explanation: This is the standard ledger of classical Indian epistemology: Cārvāka admits perception alone; Vaiśeṣika and Buddhism add inference; Sāṃkhya-Yoga add testimony; Nyāya adds comparison; Prābhākara adds postulation; Bhāṭṭa and Advaita add non-apprehension. Cārvāka sits at the **lower bound**, which is precisely why every other school must justify its additions against him. A, B and C misplace multiple schools.

MEMORY: Trap: Cārvāka is not an eccentric outlier but the minimum of a shared ledger - say so, and the answer immediately looks structural rather than descriptive.

6. Internal perception and consciousness

An opponent argues: "Internal perception gives immediate knowledge of our mental states, and in these we perceive consciousness, which is nowhere found in external material objects; so there must be an immaterial substance whose quality consciousness is." How does the Cārvāka respond?

A. He denies internal perception altogether, admitting only the five external senses.

B. He **admits** that the existence of consciousness is proved by perception, but denies that consciousness is the quality of any unperceived non-material entity - consciousness is a quality of the perceptible living body itself, since no soul is ever perceived apart from it.

C. He accepts the argument and admits an immaterial soul while denying its immortality.

D. He denies that consciousness exists.

Answer: B. He admits that the existence of consciousness is proved by perception, but denies that consciousness is the quality of any unperceived non-material entity - consciousness is a quality of the perceptible living body itself, since no soul is ever perceived apart from it.

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta give the reply verbatim in substance: "The Cārvākas admit that the existence of consciousness is proved by perception. But they deny that consciousness is the quality of any unperceived non-material or spiritual entity. As consciousness is perceived to exist in the perceptible living body composed of the material elements, it must be a quality of this body itself." D makes him an eliminativist; B would gut the very reply he needs; C contradicts *conscious body as self (dehātmavāda)*.

MEMORY: Trap: Cārvāka is a **materialist** about consciousness, not a **denier** of it.

7. Truth as an "accident"

The Cārvāka concedes that people constantly act on inference and that inferences sometimes succeed. What philosophical conclusion does he draw from that concession?

A. That all inferences are false.

B. That success proves the underlying *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)*.

C. That "truth is not an unfailing character of all inferences; it is only an **accident**, and a **separable** one" - so truth is not the essential and inseparable character that *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*-hood requires, even though people go on inferring and often succeed.

D. That inference is therefore a *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)* in practical matters.

Answer: C. That "truth is not an unfailing character of all inferences; it is only an accident, and a separable one" - so truth is not the essential and inseparable character that means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)-hood requires, even though people go on inferring and often succeed.

Explanation: The formulation is Chatterjee and Datta's: people "act uncritically on the wrong belief that our inference is true"; sometimes inference succeeds and sometimes it errs; therefore truth is "only an accident, and a separable

one, that we find only in some inferences." D and C are the very inferences the Cārvāka blocks. A overstates: he never claims all inferences are false, only that truth does not belong to inference **as such**.

MEMORY: Trap: the argument is about the **modality** of truth's attachment to inference - accidental and separable, not essential and inseparable.

8. The rejection of verbal testimony (śabda)

Which reconstruction correctly gives the Cārvāka argument against testimony as an independent *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*?

- A. Words are unreal, therefore what they express is unreal.
- B. Scripture is composed by human beings, therefore every scriptural statement is false.
- C. Only ṛṣis are reliable, and no ṛṣi is now perceivable.
- D. Words heard through the ears are **perceived**, and knowledge of words is therefore valid; but insofar as words mean things not within our perception they "are not free from error and doubt", and acceptance of an authority runs through the suppressed inference "this authority is reliable; all reliable authority should be accepted" - so testimony, being based on inference, is "as precarious as inference".

Answer: D. Words heard through the ears are perceived, and knowledge of words is therefore valid; but insofar as words mean things not within our perception they "are not free from error and doubt", and acceptance of an authority runs through the suppressed inference "this authority is reliable; all reliable authority should be accepted" - so testimony, being based on inference, is "as precarious as inference".

Explanation: This is Chatterjee and Datta's argument step for step, and it explains why the Cārvāka can reject *verbal testimony (śabda)* as a *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)* without rejecting language: sounds are perceived, meanings are not. A is false - words are perceived and real. C invents a condition of reliability the Cārvāka never accepts. B is a non sequitur; the Cārvāka's charge against the Veda is epistemic and sociological, not a general inference from human authorship to falsity.

MEMORY: Trap: rejecting testimony as a *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)* is not rejecting communication.

9. Door 1

Why, according to the Cārvāka, can *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)* not be established by perception?

- A. Because the invariable relation could be established only by knowledge of **all** cases of the mark and the probandum, and "we cannot perceive even all the cases of smoke and fire existing now in different parts of the world, to speak nothing of those which existed in the past or will exist in the future".
- B. Because *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)* is a relation between words rather than between things, and words are not perceived.
- C. Because perception is itself invalid, being contradicted by inference in cases such as the apparently flat earth.
- D. Because perception apprehends only universals and never the particulars between which the relation is supposed to hold.

Answer: A. Because the invariable relation could be established only by knowledge of all cases of the mark and the probandum, and "we cannot perceive even all the cases of smoke and fire existing now in different parts of the world, to speak nothing of those which existed in the past or will exist in the future".

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta state the argument in exactly these terms: the major premise "can be established only if we have a knowledge of all cases of smoke and presence of fire. This, however, is not possible." C is Sharma's counter-attack against the Cārvāka, not the Cārvāka's own reasoning - he accepts perception as the one *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*. D inverts the position, and would in any case describe Nyāya's *sāmānyalakṣaṇa* doctrine rather than Cārvāka's. B confuses the semantic vehicle of the universal with its content; the Cārvāka's objection is evidential, and he elsewhere insists that words heard **are** perceived.

MEMORY: **Trap**: the gap between the observed set and the universal claimed is a gap of **kind**, not of degree - no amount of further counting closes it.

10. The class-character reply

An objector says: granted we cannot perceive all individual smokes, we can perceive the class-characters "smokeness" and "fireness" and the relation between them, and so license the inference. What is the Cārvāka's two-part reply?

- A. That class-characters do not exist, since only Nyāya posits universals.
- B. That even granting perception of a relation between smokeness and fireness, no invariable relation between **all individual** cases follows - to infer a **particular** fire one must know it is inseparably related to the **particular** smoke perceived; and further, that "smokeness" itself cannot be known by perception, since not all cases of smoke are perceived. Hence "the difficulty of passing from particulars to the universal remains here as before."
- C. That the relation between class-characters is established by testimony.
- D. That class-characters are perceived only by *yogins*.

Answer: B. That even granting perception of a relation between smokeness and fireness, no invariable relation between all individual cases follows - to infer a particular fire one must know it is inseparably related to the particular smoke perceived; and further, that "smokeness" itself cannot be known by perception, since not all cases of smoke are perceived. Hence "the difficulty of passing from particulars to the universal remains here as before."

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta give both limbs: the universal-to-universal relation does not license a particular-to-particular inference, and the class-character is itself not perceptually knowable while all instances are not perceived. C invents a doctrine of yogic perception the Cārvāka would reject outright. A states a stronger ontological thesis than the reply requires. B contradicts the rejection of *verbal testimony* (*śabda*).

MEMORY: **Trap**: the reply is **two-part**; giving only one limb halves the argument.

11. Door 2 and the deduction-induction pair

Sharma summarises the Cārvāka case against inference with the line "Induction is uncertain and deduction is argument in a circle." What exactly does each half assert?

- A. That both are valid but useless.
- B. That induction is deductive and deduction is inductive.
- C. That **deduction** is a *petitio principii*, since its conclusion is already contained in a major premise whose validity is unproved; and **induction**, offered to establish that major premise, "proceeds unwarrantedly from the known to the unknown" - so each is repaired only by the other, and neither is independently secure.
- D. That deduction is invalid in form and induction is invalid in matter.

Answer: C. That deduction is a petitio principii, since its conclusion is already contained in a major premise whose validity is unproved; and induction, offered to establish that major premise, "proceeds unwarrantedly from the known to the unknown" - so each is repaired only by the other, and neither is independently secure.

Explanation: Sharma states both halves in these terms, adding the Cārvāka gibe that "the logicians ... find themselves stuck up in the mud of inference." C is wrong on the first half: the Cārvāka concedes deductive **validity** and attacks the grounding of the premise. B is incoherent; A misses the epistemic point.

MEMORY: **Trap**: the dilemma is a trap because each horn's cure is the other horn's wound.

12. Door 3's second bolt

Besides the circularity of grounding inference in testimony whose own validity is inferred, what **second** objection does the Cārvāka raise against basing *invariable concomitance* (*vyāpti*) on testimony?

- A. That testimony is a species of perception and therefore adds nothing.

- B. That testimony is always given in Sanskrit, which most people do not understand.
- C. That testimony belongs to the *āstika* schools alone.
- D. That "if inference always depended on testimony, **no one could infer anything by himself**" - which misdescribes inference, manifestly a first-person cognitive capacity, as parasitic on another's word.

Answer: D. That "if inference always depended on testimony, no one could infer anything by himself" - which misdescribes inference, manifestly a first-person cognitive capacity, as parasitic on another's word.

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta and Sharma both record this *reductio*. It is independent of the circularity objection and is regularly omitted by candidates, which is exactly why it is worth carrying. C is irrelevant; D is false of Jainism and Buddhism, which reject Vedic authority but use testimony; A confuses the perception of **sounds** with the acceptance of **content**.

MEMORY: Trap: two bolts on Door 3 - circularity **and** the first-person point.

13. The hidden limiting condition (*upādhi*) example

In the standard textbook illustration of *hidden limiting condition* (*upādhi*), which inference goes wrong, and why?

- A. A man who has repeatedly perceived fire accompanied by smoke later perceives **fire** and infers **smoke**; he errs because he failed to notice the condition (*upādhi*) of **wetness of fuel**, on the presence of which alone fire is attended with smoke.
- B. A man perceives a *gavaya* and infers a cow; he errs because similarity is not identity.
- C. A man perceives a rope and infers a snake; he errs because of defective light.
- D. A man perceives smoke and infers fire; he errs because smoke may arise without fire.

Answer: A. A man who has repeatedly perceived fire accompanied by smoke later perceives fire and infers smoke; he errs because he failed to notice the condition (*upādhi*) of wetness of fuel, on the presence of which alone fire is attended with smoke.

Explanation: This is Chatterjee and Datta's example verbatim in substance, and note the **direction**: the defective inference runs from fire to smoke, not from smoke to fire. Sharma and the authored knowledge file confirm the same case. D reverses the direction and states a claim the Cārvāka does not make in this illustration; C is the standard Advaita example of error; A concerns *comparison* (*upamāna*).

MEMORY: Trap: candidates routinely reverse this example. The *hidden limiting condition* (*upādhi*) case is **fire -> smoke**, defeated by wet fuel; a red-hot iron ball is fire without smoke.

14. The causal escape

A logician proposes: "We can ground the invariable relation between smoke and fire on a **causal** relation between them." How does the Cārvāka answer?

- A. That causation is a category of the understanding imposed by the mind.
- B. That "a causal relation, being **only a kind of invariable relation**, cannot be established by perception owing to the same difficulties" - so the proposal merely renames the problem; and repeated perception of two things occurring together cannot establish it either, since one must first be certain that no unperceived *hidden limiting condition* (*upādhi*) is operating.
- C. That causal relations are established by scripture.
- D. That causal relations hold only between material elements and therefore cannot ground any inference.

Answer: B. That "a causal relation, being only a kind of invariable relation, cannot be established by perception owing to the same difficulties" - so the proposal merely renames the problem; and repeated perception of two things occurring together cannot establish it either, since one must first be certain that no unperceived hidden limiting condition (*upādhi*) is operating.

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta give exactly this reply, and add the crucial second step about *hidden limiting condition* (*upādhi*): mere repeated co-occurrence proves nothing until unconditionality is secured, and unconditionality

"cannot be established beyond doubt by perception, as some conditions may always remain hidden". B contradicts the rejection of *verbal testimony* (*śabda*); A imports Kant; D is not the Cārvāka's argument.

MEMORY: **Trap:** the causal move is not an escape - a causal relation is a **species** of the invariable relation under attack.

15. The Socrates syllogism

According to the Cārvāka, what precisely is wrong with "All men are mortal; Socrates is a man; therefore Socrates is mortal"?

- A. The conclusion concerns a future event, and no statement about the future can be meaningful.
- B. The middle term is undistributed, making the syllogism formally invalid.
- C. Nothing in its **form** - but the major premise is an unrestricted universal functioning as *invariable concomitance* (*vyāpti*), and it can be established neither by perception (all men are never surveyed), nor by inference (*petitio principii* or regress), nor by testimony (whose own validity is inferred); the deduction therefore merely re-states what induction never secured, and is an argument in a circle.
- D. Socrates is not perceived by the speaker, so no proposition about him can be entertained.

Answer: C. Nothing in its form - but the major premise is an unrestricted universal functioning as invariable concomitance (vyāpti), and it can be established neither by perception (all men are never surveyed), nor by inference (petitio principii or regress), nor by testimony (whose own validity is inferred); the deduction therefore merely re-states what induction never secured, and is an argument in a circle.

Explanation: The Cārvāka grants formal validity and attacks the grounding of the universal; Sharma adds that the conclusion is "already contained in the major premise". B misdescribes a valid Barbara syllogism. D would abolish reference through testimony altogether, which even the Cārvāka does not do, since words are perceived. A imports a verificationist thesis about future-tensed statements that no Cārvāka source advances in this form.

MEMORY: **Trap:** never write that the Cārvāka calls the syllogism **invalid**.

16. The self-refutation charge

Which formulation states the self-refutation charge against Cārvāka most precisely?

- A. That the Cārvāka's acceptance of perception contradicts his acceptance of the four elements.
- B. That the Cārvāka contradicts scripture, which is self-refuting for any Indian school.
- C. That the Cārvāka's hedonism contradicts his materialism.
- D. That "no inference is a valid source of knowledge" is itself a **universal** proposition, not given in any single perception, so it is either inferential and self-defeating or fails its own standard; and further, as Sharma presses, thoughts, ideas and other minds "cannot be perceived; they can only be inferred", so the very act of refuting an opponent presupposes inference.

Answer: D. That "no inference is a valid source of knowledge" is itself a universal proposition, not given in any single perception, so it is either inferential and self-defeating or fails its own standard; and further, as Sharma presses, thoughts, ideas and other minds "cannot be perceived; they can only be inferred", so the very act of refuting an opponent presupposes inference.

Explanation: Sharma states the charge at length, concluding that "the self-refuted Cārvāka position is called sheer nonsense and no system of philosophy." C confuses heterodoxy with incoherence. D and A name tensions that are not the self-refutation charge - and A is not a tension at all, since the four elements are perceptible.

MEMORY: **Trap:** the sharpest form of the charge is the **other-minds** point, and it is the one most often omitted.

17. Agreement in presence (anvaya) and agreement in absence (vyatireka)

In the Nyāya construction of *invariable concomitance* (*vyāpti*), what do *agreement in presence* (*anvaya*) and *agreement in absence* (*vyatireka*) contribute, and why is the pair stronger than mere counting?

A. *Agreement in presence (anvaya)* is agreement in presence - wherever the *hetu*, there the *sādhya*; *agreement in absence (vyatireka)* is agreement in absence - where the *sādhya* is absent, the *hetu* is absent. Together they make *bhūyodarśana* a **structured search for counter-instances** rather than a tally, so that a relation surviving deliberate attempts to find *hetu*-without-*sādhya* has a warrant that a mere count does not.

B. *Agreement in presence (anvaya)* is perception and *agreement in absence (vyatireka)* is inference.

C. *Agreement in presence (anvaya)* is the elimination of *upādhis* and *agreement in absence (vyatireka)* is hypothetical reasoning.

D. *Agreement in presence (anvaya)* is the major premise and *agreement in absence (vyatireka)* the minor premise of the five-membered syllogism.

Answer: A. Agreement in presence (anvaya) is agreement in presence - wherever the hetu, there the sādhya; agreement in absence (vyatireka) is agreement in absence - where the sādhya is absent, the hetu is absent. Together they make bhūyodarśana a structured search for counter-instances rather than a tally, so that a relation surviving deliberate attempts to find hetu-without-sādhya has a warrant that a mere count does not.

Explanation: The authored Nyāya file lists repeated observation (*bhūyodarśana*), supportive reasoning (*tarka*) and elimination of *hidden limiting condition (upādhi)* as the means of establishing *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)*, and the joint method of co-presence and co-absence is the disciplined form the observation takes. D misdescribes the *pañcāvayava* structure; B and C misassign the terms - *hidden limiting condition (upādhi)*-elimination and *hypothetical reasoning (tarka)* are distinct stages.

MEMORY: Trap: the Nyāya answer to Cārvāka is **negative-case testing**, not "we have seen many cases".

18. Hypothetical reasoning (tarka)

What is *hypothetical reasoning (tarka)*, and what is its status in Nyāya?

A. The extraordinary perception through which a universal is presented in a particular.

B. Not a *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)* at all but a *pramāṇa-anugrahaka* - an auxiliary: by assuming the contradictory of a proposed relation and exhibiting an unacceptable consequence (*aniṣṭa-prasaṅga*), it removes the doubt that would otherwise block the grasp of *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)*.

C. The technical name for the fallacy of the undistributed middle.

D. A fifth *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)* alongside perception, inference, comparison and testimony.

Answer: B. Not a means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa) at all but a pramāṇa-anugrahaka - an auxiliary: by assuming the contradictory of a proposed relation and exhibiting an unacceptable consequence (aniṣṭa-prasaṅga), it removes the doubt that would otherwise block the grasp of invariable concomitance (vyāpti).

Explanation: Nyāya expressly refuses *hypothetical reasoning (tarka)* independent *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)* status while assigning it a decisive doubt-removing role; the authored Nyāya file lists it among the means of establishing *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)* alongside repeated observation and *hidden limiting condition (upādhi)*-elimination. D promotes it wrongly; A describes *sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa*; B confuses a supportive method with a formal fallacy.

MEMORY: Trap: *hypothetical reasoning (tarka)* proves nothing by itself - say so, and the answer sounds like Nyāya rather than like a summary of Nyāya.

19. Sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa

How does Nyāya answer the Cārvāka objection that "smokeness" cannot be perceived because not all smokes are perceived?

A. By arguing that "smokeness" is a mere name with no cognitive content.

B. By denying that universals exist.

C. Through **sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa**, an extraordinary perception in which the universal itself is presented *through* any perceived particular - so the universal is not reached by adding up instances, and it is an error to say that Nyāya denies the perception of universals.

D. By conceding the point and grounding *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)* in scripture instead.

Answer: C. Through sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa, an extraordinary perception in which the universal itself is presented through any perceived particular - so the universal is not reached by adding up instances, and it is an error to say that Nyāya denies the perception of universals.

Explanation: The authored Nyāya file lists as a standard trap the claim "that universals are not perceived. Nyāya allows their perception through **sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa**." D abandons Nyāya's insistence that inference is *independent* of testimony; C and A are nominalist positions Nyāya explicitly rejects.

MEMORY: Trap: the device works only inside Nyāya's realism about universals - say so, and your evaluation looks balanced rather than partisan.

20. Parāmarśa

Why does the concept of *parāmarśa* undercut the Cārvāka's description of inference as "a leap in the dark"?

A. Because *parāmarśa* is the elimination of all *upādhis* prior to inferring.

B. Because *parāmarśa* is a second perception that confirms the first.

C. Because *parāmarśa* is a scriptural warrant for the inference.

D. Because *parāmarśa* is the operative cognition (*karaṇa*) of *anumiti* - the apprehension of the mark **as qualified by** its invariable concomitance ("this hill has smoke which is invariably accompanied by fire") - so the conclusion arises from a single complex cognition and there is no moment at which the mind is stranded between premises with a gap to cross.

Answer: D. Because parāmarśa is the operative cognition (karaṇa) of anumiti - the apprehension of the mark as qualified by its invariable concomitance ("this hill has smoke which is invariably accompanied by fire") - so the conclusion arises from a single complex cognition and there is no moment at which the mind is stranded between premises with a gap to cross.

Explanation: For Nyāya the inferential cognition is generated by *parāmarśa*, not by a psychological jump from one perception to an absent object. B, D and A misdescribe the concept - respectively as a further perception, a scriptural licence, and a stage of *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)*-formation.

MEMORY: Trap: the memorable contrast - for Cārvāka a jump in the dark, for Nyāya a step taken in the light of a concomitance already grasped.

21. Four elements, not five

Which statement about Cārvāka cosmology is correct?

A. Cārvāka admits earth, water, fire and air, and rejects *ākāśa* because it is not perceived but only inferred - from sound to an imperceptible substrate - and inference is not a *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*.

B. Cārvāka admits *ākāśa* but denies that sound is its quality.

C. Cārvāka admits five elements but denies that they are eternal.

D. Cārvāka admits only earth and water, treating fire and air as their modifications.

Answer: A. Cārvāka admits earth, water, fire and air, and rejects ākāśa because it is not perceived but only inferred - from sound to an imperceptible substrate - and inference is not a means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa).

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta: the Cārvākas "reject ether, because its existence cannot be perceived; it has to be inferred." Sharma states the same. B contradicts Sharma's further point that "the elements are **eternal**, but their combinations undergo production and dissolution". A and D have no textual basis.

MEMORY: **Trap:** "five elements" is the single most examined factual error in this syllabus item.

22. Eternity and combination

What is the correct Cārvāka position on the permanence of the elements and of the things composed from them?

- A. The elements are eternal and their combinations are equally eternal, so nothing ever perishes.
- B. The elements are **eternal**, while their combinations "undergo production and dissolution" - so Cārvāka is a realist materialism with a stable substrate, not a doctrine of universal flux; living bodies are combinations that are "reduced on death" to the elements.
- C. Both the elements and their combinations are momentary.
- D. The elements are produced by God and are therefore contingent.

Answer: B. The elements are eternal, while their combinations "undergo production and dissolution" - so Cārvāka is a realist materialism with a stable substrate, not a doctrine of universal flux; living bodies are combinations that are "reduced on death" to the elements.

Explanation: Sharma states the doctrine exactly, and Chatterjee and Datta supply the biological corollary that living organisms are composed of the four elements, "by the combination of which they are produced and to which they are reduced on death." C imports Buddhist momentariness; D imports a creator the school denies; B contradicts the observed dissolution of bodies.

MEMORY: **Trap:** this is what makes Cārvāka a **realist** materialism and sharpens its contrast with Buddhist *kṣaṇikavāda*.

23. Two analogies, two objections

The betel analogy and the fermentation analogy both support *emergent consciousness from material elements* (*bhūta-caitanya-vāda*). What distinct work does each do?

- A. Both answer the same objection, that consciousness cannot be perceived.
- B. The betel analogy is Nyāya's and the fermentation analogy Cārvāka's.
- C. The **betel** analogy answers the objection that consciousness is present in none of the elements taken separately, by showing that a combination of different ingredients - leaf, lime and nut, "none of which is originally red" - may exhibit a property absent from each; the **fermentation** analogy answers the objection that the elements are unchanged before and after, by showing that "even the same thing placed under a different condition may develop qualities originally absent", as molasses becomes intoxicant on fermenting.
- D. The betel analogy establishes that consciousness is a colour and the fermentation analogy that it is a power.

Answer: C. The betel analogy answers the objection that consciousness is present in none of the elements taken separately, by showing that a combination of different ingredients - leaf, lime and nut, "none of which is originally red" - may exhibit a property absent from each; the fermentation analogy answers the objection that the elements are unchanged before and after, by showing that "even the same thing placed under a different condition may develop qualities originally absent", as molasses becomes intoxicant on fermenting.

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta give the two cases with exactly this division of labour - compositional emergence and transformational emergence. B misattributes both; indeed the fermentation case appears in the transmitted *Bṛhaspati sūtra kiṇvādhībhya madaśaktivad vijñānam*. A collapses two distinct arguments; D is a category confusion.

MEMORY: **Trap:** present them as **two** analogies answering **two** objections, not as one illustration repeated.

24. Pot, potter and svabhāva

An objector argues that a jar requires not only clay (material cause) but a potter (efficient cause), so the four elements need God as the world's shaper. What is the Cārvāka reply, and what labels does it earn?

- A. That the analogy fails because jars are perceived and the world is not.

- B. That the elements are shaped by *adr̥ṣṭa* rather than by God.
- C. That God exists but is the material rather than the efficient cause.
- D. That "the material elements themselves have got each its fixed nature (*svabhāva*)", by whose inherent natures and laws they combine, so "there is thus no necessity for God" and "there is no proof that the objects of the world are the products of any design" - earning the labels **naturalism** (*svabhāvavāda*), **mechanism** (*yadṛcchāvāda*) and, in the textbook's own words, **positivism**, "because it believes only in positive facts or observable phenomena".

Answer: D. That "the material elements themselves have got each its fixed nature (*svabhāva*)", by whose inherent natures and laws they combine, so "there is thus no necessity for God" and "there is no proof that the objects of the world are the products of any design" - earning the labels naturalism (*svabhāvavāda*), mechanism (*yadṛcchāvāda*) and, in the textbook's own words, positivism, "because it believes only in positive facts or observable phenomena".

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta give the exchange and then supply all three labels in the same passage. B retains *adr̥ṣṭa*, which the school explicitly rejects as an unperceived law. D is Vedāntic, not Cārvāka. A is not the reply given, and would concede the design question.

MEMORY: Trap: note the internal tension worth flagging in an answer - *explanation through natural properties* (*svabhāvavāda*) grounds regularity in fixed natures, while *yadṛcchāvāda* calls the world's objects "fortuitous products".

25. The formula of conscious body as self (*dehātmavāda*)

What does *caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ* assert, and what does it not assert?

- A. It asserts that the person **is** the body **qualified by consciousness** - that is, the living, conscious body, identical with the self, not merely correlated with it; it does **not** assert that the self is a corpse, that there is no self at all, or that consciousness is identical with any single element.
- B. It asserts that the body is an instrument used by the self.
- C. It asserts that consciousness is a fifth element.
- D. It asserts that the self is the *sensory mind* (*manas*) rather than the gross body.

Answer: A. It asserts that the person is the body qualified by consciousness - that is, the living, conscious body, identical with the self, not merely correlated with it; it does not assert that the self is a corpse, that there is no self at all, or that consciousness is identical with any single element.

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta render the Cārvāka position as "this conscious living body (*caitanya-viśiṣṭa deha eva ātmā*)". B contradicts the four-element doctrine. A is Sharma's *objection* - that the body is "a mere instrument for the manifestation of consciousness" - not the Cārvāka thesis. C names one of Sadānanda's four materialist variants recorded in the *Vedāntasāra*, not the mainstream formula.

MEMORY: Trap: every word of the formula is load-bearing; "qualified by consciousness" is what makes a body a **self**.

26. The argument from first-person statements

What is the logical force of the Cārvāka appeal to judgements like "I am fat", "I am lame", "I am blind"?

- A. That the soul possesses bodily attributes by inherence.
- B. That bodily predicates are attached directly to "I" in ordinary self-ascription, which is intelligible only if the subject and the bearer of the predicate are the same thing; were the "I" an immaterial soul, these would be **meaningless** category mistakes - so the burden falls on the dualist to explain why ordinary self-description runs this way.
- C. That such statements are figurative and therefore prove nothing.
- D. That the body is the object of self-knowledge but not its subject.

Answer: B. That bodily predicates are attached directly to "I" in ordinary self-ascription, which is intelligible only if the subject and the bearer of the predicate are the same thing; were the "I" an immaterial soul, these

would be meaningless category mistakes - so the burden falls on the dualist to explain why ordinary self-description runs this way.

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta: "we have direct evidence of the identity of the self with the body in our daily experiences and judgments like, 'I am fat,' 'I am lame,' 'I am blind'. If the 'I', the self, were different from the body, **these would be meaningless.**" B is the dualist's *reply*, not the argument. D and A concede the dualist framework the argument is designed to challenge.

MEMORY: Trap: the argument shifts the burden; it does not by itself prove materialism, and saying so improves the answer.

27. Sharma's objection battery

Which pair of objections, taken together, shows that the Cārvāka's evidence establishes only **dependence** of consciousness on the body rather than **production** by it?

- A. That the *Bṛhaspati-sūtra* is lost, and that Jayarāśi attacks perception.
- B. That consciousness is private, and that the Vedas are authorless.
- C. That in swoons, fits, epilepsy and dreamless sleep the living body is seen **without** consciousness while in dreams consciousness is seen without the living body; and that mere co-existence is not causation - "the eye cannot see in darkness. Sight is not possible without light, yet light cannot be regarded as the cause of sight", just as "the two horns of a bull which are always found together cannot be regarded as causally related" - so "the body is a mere **instrument** for the manifestation of consciousness and cannot be regarded as its cause".
- D. That animals lack rational consciousness, and that the elements are eternal.

Answer: C. That in swoons, fits, epilepsy and dreamless sleep the living body is seen without consciousness while in dreams consciousness is seen without the living body; and that mere co-existence is not causation - "the eye cannot see in darkness. Sight is not possible without light, yet light cannot be regarded as the cause of sight", just as "the two horns of a bull which are always found together cannot be regarded as causally related" - so "the body is a mere instrument for the manifestation of consciousness and cannot be regarded as its cause".

Explanation: Sharma advances precisely this pair, and their joint effect is to sever the inference from constant co-occurrence to causation. B pairs a genuine objection with an irrelevant Mīmāṃsā doctrine. C pairs a weaker objection with a doctrine that is not an objection at all. A concerns sources, not the mind-body question.

MEMORY: Trap: the honest verdict is that both sides argue from the same evidence to different best explanations - say so rather than declaring a winner.

28. Cārvāka versus Buddhist denial of self

Which statement differentiates the two denials of *enduring self* (*ātman*) most precisely?

- A. Cārvāka accepts rebirth without a soul; Buddhism denies rebirth.
- B. Both deny the self for identical reasons, differing only in vocabulary.
- C. Cārvāka denies the self on soteriological grounds, Buddhism on epistemological grounds.
- D. Cārvāka denies the self's **transcendence** while retaining a substantial bearer - the living body - on **epistemic** grounds, and terminates the moral narrative at death; Buddhism denies **substantiality** as such on **ontological and soteriological** grounds (*pratītyasamutpāda*, *kṣaṇikavāda*, and the claim that self-belief breeds craving), replacing the bearer with the *santāna* so that action and moral consequence (karma), rebirth and *cessation of conditioned suffering* (*nirvāṇa*) are preserved - and since *rūpa* is itself one of the five *skandhas*, this analysis rules out the Cārvāka body-self by name.

Answer: D. Cārvāka denies the self's transcendence while retaining a substantial bearer - the living body - on epistemic grounds, and terminates the moral narrative at death; Buddhism denies substantiality as such on ontological and soteriological grounds (pratītyasamutpāda, kṣaṇikavāda, and the claim that self-belief breeds craving), replacing the bearer with the santāna so that action and moral consequence (karma), rebirth and

cessation of conditioned suffering (nirvāṇa) are preserved - and since rūpa is itself one of the five skandhas, this analysis rules out the Cārvāka body-self by name.

Explanation: The authored Buddhism file states that Cārvāka "denies self beyond body and tends toward materialist reduction" while Buddhism "denies permanent self but does not reduce personhood simply to gross body", concluding that "both reject an eternal *enduring self* (*ātman*), but for very different reasons and with very different moral-metaphysical consequences." C reverses the grounds; A inverts both positions on rebirth; B is the error the 2024 question was set to detect.

MEMORY: **Trap:** the one-line formula - Cārvāka **relocates** the self, Buddhism **dissolves** it.

29. Adṛṣṭa and transmigration

Why is *adṛṣṭa* the ideal test case for the Cārvāka's epistemic principle, and what does its rejection entail?

- A. Because *adṛṣṭa* is by definition "the unseen" - an entity whose very name announces its imperceptibility - so an epistemology admitting only perception must refuse it; and with it falls the carrier of moral desert across time, which is one of the four things transmigration requires, alongside a self distinct from the body, that self's survival after death, and knowledge that any of these obtains.
- B. Because *adṛṣṭa* is another name for *svabhāva*.
- C. Because *adṛṣṭa* is accepted only by the Jainas.
- D. Because *adṛṣṭa* is a perceptible quality of the soul.

Answer: A. Because *adṛṣṭa* is by definition "the unseen" - an entity whose very name announces its imperceptibility - so an epistemology admitting only perception must refuse it; and with it falls the carrier of moral desert across time, which is one of the four things transmigration requires, alongside a self distinct from the body, that self's survival after death, and knowledge that any of these obtains.

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta name it among the casualties: "God, soul, heaven, life before birth or after death, and **any unperceived law (like *adṛṣṭa*)** cannot be believed in, because they are all beyond perception." C is false - *adṛṣṭa* is a Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika and Mīmāṃsā device. D contradicts its definition. B confuses an unseen moral potency with an inherent natural disposition, which is the very substitution the Cārvāka makes *against* it.

MEMORY: **Trap:** *svabhāva* is what the Cārvāka puts **in place of *adṛṣṭa***, not a synonym for it.

30. Maraṇam eva apavargaḥ

What is the correct reading of the transmitted *sūtra* "death alone is liberation"?

- A. A recommendation of suicide as the highest human end.
- B. A *reductio* of the very concept of *liberation* (*mokṣa*): if liberation means the soul's freedom from bodily bondage it is "absurd because there is no soul", and if it means a state free from all pain in this life it is "an impossible ideal", since embodiment "is bound up with pleasure as well as pain" - so the only state satisfying the definition is death, "and no wise man would willingly work for that end".
- C. A ritual prescription for the moment of death.
- D. The Jaina doctrine that liberation is attained at the moment of bodily death.

Answer: B. A *reductio* of the very concept of liberation (*mokṣa*): if liberation means the soul's freedom from bodily bondage it is "absurd because there is no soul", and if it means a state free from all pain in this life it is "an impossible ideal", since embodiment "is bound up with pleasure as well as pain" - so the only state satisfying the definition is death, "and no wise man would willingly work for that end".

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta set out both horns and the residue, adding the decisive clause that no wise man would work for such an end - which by itself refutes B. D attributes a soul the school denies. C restores the ritual efficacy the school rejects.

MEMORY: **Trap:** the verse attacks the **coherence of the goal**, not the value of life.

31. Ethics and the two Cārvākas

Which statement about Cārvāka ethics is accurate on the textbooks' own evidence?

- A. All Cārvākas were gross sensualists, and no source suggests otherwise.
- B. Cārvāka accepts *dharma* and *material well-being (artha)* while rejecting *pleasure (kāma)* and *liberation (mokṣa)*.
- C. *Pleasure (kāma)* is the ultimate end and *material well-being (artha)* only its **means**, while *dharma* is rejected because "virtue and vice are distinctions made by the **scriptures**, whose authority cannot be rationally accepted" and *liberation (mokṣa)* because it is obtainable only by death; and the sources distinguish **dhūrta** (cunning) from **suśikṣita** (cultured) Cārvākas, with the sixty-four fine arts, the incorporation of *daṇḍanīti* and *vārttā*, the report that some regarded the **king as God**, and Vātsyāyana's disciplined hedonism as evidence of the refined strand.
- D. Cārvāka ethics is deontological, grounding duty in the fixed natures of things.

Answer: C. Pleasure (kāma) is the ultimate end and material well-being (artha) only its means, while dharma is rejected because "virtue and vice are distinctions made by the scriptures, whose authority cannot be rationally accepted" and liberation (mokṣa) because it is obtainable only by death; and the sources distinguish dhūrta (cunning) from suśikṣita (cultured) Cārvākas, with the sixty-four fine arts, the incorporation of daṇḍanīti and vārttā, the report that some regarded the king as God, and Vātsyāyana's disciplined hedonism as evidence of the refined strand.

Explanation: Every clause is from Chatterjee and Datta, who add that "egoistic hedonism in its gross form is not compatible with social discipline" and that the *dhūrta* / *suśikṣita* distinction "makes it likely that the Cārvākas were not all of the same gross, uncultured type." A ignores that distinction. C inverts the verdict on all four *puruṣārthas*. D is incompatible with a hedonistic value theory.

MEMORY: Trap: *dharma* is rejected on **epistemic** grounds - it is a scriptural category - not because pleasure is more agreeable.

32. The positivism verdict

Which is the most defensible verdict on whether Cārvāka's philosophy is positivistic?

- A. Straightforwardly no, since positivism is a nineteenth-century European movement and cross-traditional comparison is illegitimate.
- B. Straightforwardly yes, since both admit only observable phenomena.
- C. Yes, because Comte's law of three stages is anticipated in the *Bṛhaspati-sūtra*.
- D. Positivistic in **spirit** - an empiricist criterion, an anti-metaphysical temper, suspicion of unverifiable authority, and even a quasi-verificationist register in which questions about rebirth become "meaningless", a resemblance the standard textbook itself endorses by calling the theory "positivism ... because it believes only in positive facts or observable phenomena" - but **not** in **method**, since positivism is built on the inference Cārvāka denies *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*-status and possesses a constructive programme, formal tools and (in Comte) a philosophy of history that Cārvāka wholly lacks. The safer labels are **radical empiricism** or **naturalistic materialism**.

Answer: D. Positivistic in spirit - an empiricist criterion, an anti-metaphysical temper, suspicion of unverifiable authority, and even a quasi-verificationist register in which questions about rebirth become "meaningless", a resemblance the standard textbook itself endorses by calling the theory "positivism ... because it believes only in positive facts or observable phenomena" - but not in method, since positivism is built on the inference Cārvāka denies means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)-status and possesses a constructive programme, formal tools and (in Comte) a philosophy of history that Cārvāka wholly lacks. The safer labels are radical empiricism or naturalistic materialism.

Explanation: Chatterjee and Datta both apply the label and supply the material that qualifies it, since they also record the wholesale denial of inference and compare the Cārvāka view of inference to that of "the pragmatists and logical positivists". B ignores the methodological chasm; A refuses a comparison the tradition of exposition has itself made; D invents a claim about a lost text.

MEMORY: **Trap:** the decisive paradox - Cārvāka reaches a **materialist** conclusion by an **anti-inferential** route, whereas modern materialism reaches it by a thoroughly inferential one.

33. Which statement best captures Cārvāka's criticism of Vedic ritual without reducing it to mere abuse?

- A. The decisive criticism is epistemic: ritual promises an unseen result through Vedic testimony, but neither the authority of the text nor the link between sacrifice and heaven is perceptually established; the social polemic against priests is secondary.
- B. Every ritual is false because fire cannot transform material objects.
- C. Ritual is rejected only because it causes physical pain.
- D. Cārvāka accepts ritual when performed without priests.

Answer: A. The decisive criticism is epistemic: ritual promises an unseen result through Vedic testimony, but neither the authority of the text nor the link between sacrifice and heaven is perceptually established; the social polemic against priests is secondary.

Explanation: The school first rejects *verbal testimony (śabda)* as an independent *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)* and then refuses the unseen causal bridge from an observable offering to *svarga* or merit. Doxographical ridicule can illustrate this derivation, but treating ridicule as the argument would confuse rhetoric with epistemology.

34. Which comparison between Cārvāka and Jainism is accurate?

- A. Both admit six substances but disagree about their qualities.
- B. Cārvāka admits four perceptible *bhūtas*, whereas Jainism admits six *dravyas* and defines reality through origination, decay and persistence; Jaina *dharma* and *adharma* are media of motion and rest, not moral merit and demerit.
- C. Cārvāka accepts *ākāśa*, while Jainism rejects it.
- D. Both identify consciousness as an accidental product of matter.

Answer: B. Cārvāka admits four perceptible bhūtas, whereas Jainism admits six dravyas and defines reality through origination, decay and persistence; Jaina dharma and adharma are media of motion and rest, not moral merit and demerit.

Explanation: This answer combines ontology, the Jaina formula *utpāda-vyaya-dhrauṇya*, and a classic factual trap. Jainism accepts *ākāśa* and treats consciousness as the inseparable nature of *individual self (jīva)*; Cārvāka rejects both claims as inference-dependent.

35. A question asks whether Cārvāka is "positivistic." Which answer strategy best obeys the directive?

- A. Narrate Comte's law of three stages and mention Cārvāka in the conclusion.
- B. Answer yes because both deny God.
- C. Give a graded verdict: positivistic in anti-metaphysical and experience-oriented spirit, but not in scientific method because positivism relies on disciplined inference; prefer "radical empiricism" or "naturalistic materialism."
- D. Reject the comparison because Western categories may never be used in Indian philosophy.

Answer: C. Give a graded verdict: positivistic in anti-metaphysical and experience-oriented spirit, but not in scientific method because positivism relies on disciplined inference; prefer "radical empiricism" or "naturalistic materialism."

Explanation: The directive asks for reasons and justification, so a binary label is insufficient. The decisive disanalogy is not atheism but inference: scientific positivism preserves theoretical and inductive reasoning that the strong Cārvāka thesis denies *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*-status.

36. Which statement about Cārvāka ethics is the safest examiner-grade formulation?

- A. It commands indiscriminate sensual indulgence regardless of consequences.
- B. It accepts *dharma* as social convention while rejecting only *liberation (mokṣa)*.

C. It rejects *material well-being (artha)* because wealth delays pleasure.

D. It privileges this-worldly *pleasure (kāma)* and the material means of *material well-being (artha)* after rejecting scripture-dependent *dharma* and post-mortem *liberation (mokṣa)*, but a strong reconstruction allows prudence, deferred gratification and social consequences rather than crude self-destruction.

Answer: D. It privileges this-worldly pleasure (kāma) and the material means of material well-being (artha) after rejecting scripture-dependent dharma and post-mortem liberation (mokṣa), but a strong reconstruction allows prudence, deferred gratification and social consequences rather than crude self-destruction.

Explanation: Cārvāka ethics follows from its finite embodied horizon, not from a command to act irrationally. Hostile doxography may exaggerate gross hedonism; the philosophically defensible version is prudential, though still thin on independent duties to others.

37. What is the most defensible relation between Cārvāka's strong and soft readings of inference?

A. The strong reading denies *inference (anumāna)* independent *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*-status because *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)* lacks certainty; the soft reading permits corrigible, perception-bound practical expectation while refusing inference to establish supersensible entities.

B. The strong reading accepts scientific inference, while the soft reading rejects it.

C. The soft reading is Jayarāṣi's claim that perception alone is infallible.

D. Both readings claim every inference is false.

Answer: A. The strong reading denies inference (anumāna) independent means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)-status because invariable concomitance (vyāpti) lacks certainty; the soft reading permits corrigible, perception-bound practical expectation while refusing inference to establish supersensible entities.

Explanation: The distinction separates *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*-status from ordinary action. It avoids the factual error that Cārvākas never form expectations, but its cost is doctrinal shrinkage: once useful inference is admitted, the disagreement with Nyāya increasingly concerns certainty and transcendental reach.

38. Which statement correctly distinguishes Cārvāka's body-self from Buddhist no-self?

A. Both identify the person exclusively with *rūpa*.

B. Cārvāka relocates selfhood into the conscious body, while Buddhism denies selfhood to body and mind alike by analysing the person into five conditioned *skandhas* and preserving continuity through a causal stream rather than a substance.

C. Buddhism rejects action and moral consequence (karma) and rebirth because it rejects *enduring self (ātman)*.

D. Cārvāka accepts a mental stream after bodily death.

Answer: B. Cārvāka relocates selfhood into the conscious body, while Buddhism denies selfhood to body and mind alike by analysing the person into five conditioned skandhas and preserving continuity through a causal stream rather than a substance.

Explanation: *Rūpa* is itself only one *skandha*, so Buddhism rejects the Cārvāka body-self as well as an immaterial soul. Their aftermaths diverge: Cārvāka ends action and moral consequence (karma) and rebirth at death, whereas Buddhism retains both without a permanent owner.

39. In a 2020 answer on ākāśa and transmigration, which organizing thesis is strongest?

A. The rejection of *ākāśa* is scientific, while rejection of transmigration is ethical.

B. The two topics are unrelated and should be answered as separate notes.

C. Both are applications of one epistemic restriction: *ākāśa* is an inferred substrate and transmigration requires an unperceived surviving self, karmic carrier and post-mortem process; therefore both denials are as strong and as vulnerable as the rejection of inference.

D. Cārvāka rejects *ākāśa* but accepts a transmigrating material soul.

Answer: C. Both are applications of one epistemic restriction: ākāśa is an inferred substrate and transmigration requires an unperceived surviving self, karmic carrier and post-mortem process; therefore both denials are as strong and as vulnerable as the rejection of inference.

Explanation: This thesis obeys both directives while supplying unity. A high-scoring answer still evaluates each half separately, especially the slide from "not established" to "unreal" and the distinction between bodily dependence and production of consciousness.

40. Which source-attribution sentence is methodologically sound?

- A. "The extant *Bṛhaspati-sūtra* definitively proves that every Cārvāka accepted crude hedonism."
- B. "Because the sources are hostile, no Cārvāka doctrine can be reconstructed."
- C. "Jayarāśi's scepticism is the official and uniform doctrine of all Lokāyatas."
- D. "On the standard reconstruction derived from convergent but largely hostile witnesses, Cārvāka affirms perceptualism and materialism; the lost *Bṛhaspati-sūtra*, internal diversity and Jayarāśi's contested affiliation require caution about quotations and uniformity."

Answer: D. "On the standard reconstruction derived from convergent but largely hostile witnesses, Cārvāka affirms perceptualism and materialism; the lost *Bṛhaspati-sūtra*, internal diversity and Jayarāśi's contested affiliation require caution about quotations and uniformity."

Explanation: Responsible reconstruction avoids both credulity and despair. Convergence supports a doctrinal core, while source loss prevents fabricated quotations or claims that one surviving sceptical text straightforwardly represents the standard school.

REMEDIAL DIAGNOSTIC MCQS

Questions 41-48 repair recurrent factual, attribution and directive errors. The same B → D → C → A rotation continues.

41. "Denies the self" versus "denies a transcendental self"

A student writes: "Cārvāka, like Buddhism, denies the self." Which correction is required?

- A. Cārvāka denies the **transcendental, immaterial** self and positively affirms a **material** one - *caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ*, the body qualified by consciousness - whereas Buddhism denies **substantiality** as such, including the body-self, since *rūpa* is itself one of the five *skandhas*; the two are therefore not the same denial, and Buddhist analysis refutes Cārvāka's self as decisively as it refutes Nyāya's.
- B. Both deny the self identically; the difference is only terminological.
- C. Buddhism denies the self only in the Mahāyāna schools.
- D. Cārvāka denies the self entirely and Buddhism affirms a permanent self.

Answer: A. Cārvāka denies the transcendental, immaterial self and positively affirms a material one - *caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ*, the body qualified by consciousness - whereas Buddhism denies substantiality as such, including the body-self, since *rūpa* is itself one of the five *skandhas*; the two are therefore not the same denial, and Buddhist analysis refutes Cārvāka's self as decisively as it refutes Nyāya's.

Explanation:

42. "Rejects inference" versus "never infers"

A student writes: "According to Cārvāka nobody ever infers anything, since inference is impossible." Which correction is required?

- A. Cārvāka rejects inference only when it is used by Naiyāyikas.
- B. Cārvāka denies inference **as a means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)**, that is, as a truth-guaranteeing means; he explicitly concedes that "in life we very often act unsuspectingly on inference" and that inference sometimes succeeds, concluding only that "truth is not an unfailing character of all inferences; it is only an **accident**, and a **separable** one" -

and his sharpest target is **transcendental** inference, which no perception could ever check.

C. Cārvāka accepts inference as a *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)* in worldly matters and rejects it only in scripture.

D. Cārvāka rejects perception as well, following Jayarāṣi.

Answer: B. Cārvāka denies inference as a means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa), that is, as a truth-guaranteeing means; he explicitly concedes that "in life we very often act unsuspectingly on inference" and that inference sometimes succeeds, concluding only that "truth is not an unfailing character of all inferences; it is only an accident, and a separable one" - and his sharpest target is transcendental inference, which no perception could ever check.

Explanation:

43. Svabhāva versus adṛṣṭa

A student writes: "Cārvāka explains the world's regularity by *adṛṣṭa*, the inherent unseen power of things." Which correction is required?

A. *Adṛṣṭa* is a Cārvāka term meaning the fixed nature of the elements.

B. Cārvāka accepts *adṛṣṭa* but denies *action and moral consequence (karma)*.

C. **Adṛṣṭa** is the **unseen moral potency** of Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika and Mīmāṃsā that links an act to a later fruit, and Cārvāka rejects it by name - Chatterjee and Datta list "any unperceived law (like *adṛṣṭa*)" among the casualties; what Cārvāka puts **in its place** is **svabhāva**, the inherent natural disposition of the elements, which explains regularity without moral bookkeeping.

D. Both terms are synonyms in classical Indian philosophy.

Answer: C. Adṛṣṭa is the unseen moral potency of Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika and Mīmāṃsā that links an act to a later fruit, and Cārvāka rejects it by name - Chatterjee and Datta list "any unperceived law (like adṛṣṭa)" among the casualties; what Cārvāka puts in its place is svabhāva, the inherent natural disposition of the elements, which explains regularity without moral bookkeeping.

Explanation:

44. Hidden limiting condition (upādhi) versus incomplete enumeration

A student writes: "The *hidden limiting condition (upādhi)* objection is simply the point that we have not observed enough cases." Which correction is required?

A. *Hidden limiting condition (upādhi)* applies only to inferences about the future.

B. *Hidden limiting condition (upādhi)* is the Nyāya name for the middle term.

C. *Hidden limiting condition (upādhi)* means a defect in the form of the syllogism.

D. Incomplete enumeration is a defect of **sample size**, curable in principle by further observation; the **hidden limiting condition (upādhi)** objection is that even exhaustively observed regularity may track an **unnoticed condition**, so that what remains uncertified is the **identification of the relevant ground** of the relation - Chatterjee and Datta: "unconditionality ... cannot be established beyond doubt by perception, as some conditions may **always remain hidden and escape notice**." This is why Nyāya must introduce *hypothetical reasoning (tarka)* rather than merely more observation.

Answer: D. Incomplete enumeration is a defect of sample size, curable in principle by further observation; the hidden limiting condition (upādhi) objection is that even exhaustively observed regularity may track an unnoticed condition, so that what remains uncertified is the identification of the relevant ground of the relation - Chatterjee and Datta: "unconditionality ... cannot be established beyond doubt by perception, as some conditions may always remain hidden and escape notice." This is why Nyāya must introduce hypothetical reasoning (tarka) rather than merely more observation.

Explanation:

45. Naturalism, mechanism and positivism

A student writes: "Cārvāka's *explanation through natural properties* (*svabhāvavāda*) is a scientific naturalism, and therefore Cārvāka is a positivist." Which correction is required?

A. *Explanation through natural properties* (*svabhāvavāda*) is a **metaphysical refusal of teleology**, not an experimental programme; the textbook applies three distinct labels - naturalism (*svabhāvavāda*), mechanism (*yadr̥cchāvāda*, which denies conscious purpose and treats the world as a fortuitous combination) and positivism ("because it believes only in positive facts or observable phenomena") - and the positivism label must in any case be qualified, since positivism runs on the very inference Cārvāka denies. Note also the internal tension between grounding regularity in fixed **natures** and calling the world's objects **fortuitous**.

B. *Explanation through natural properties* (*svabhāvavāda*) is a Sāṃkhya doctrine, not a Cārvāka one.

C. *Yadr̥cchāvāda* means "the doctrine of divine will".

D. Cārvāka has no explanatory principle at all.

Answer: A. Explanation through natural properties (svabhāvavāda) is a metaphysical refusal of teleology, not an experimental programme; the textbook applies three distinct labels - naturalism (svabhāvavāda), mechanism (yadr̥cchāvāda, which denies conscious purpose and treats the world as a fortuitous combination) and positivism ("because it believes only in positive facts or observable phenomena") - and the positivism label must in any case be qualified, since positivism runs on the very inference Cārvāka denies. Note also the internal tension between grounding regularity in fixed natures and calling the world's objects fortuitous.

Explanation:

46. What survives of the Bṛhaspati-sūtra

A student writes: "As Bṛhaspati says in his *Sūtra*, earth, water, fire and air are the elements." Which correction is required?

A. The *sūtra* is genuine but was composed by Cārvāka rather than Bṛhaspati.

B. The **Bṛhaspati-sūtra is lost**; about a **dozen sūtras** and verses survive only as **quotations in other authors' works**, so the correct form is "as transmitted in the *sūtra* quoted by later authors" or "on the standard reconstruction" - the content of *pr̥thivyāptejovāyuriti tattvāni* is well attested, but its textual status is not that of an available primary source.

C. The *Bṛhaspati-sūtra* survives complete and may be quoted directly.

D. The *sūtra* is preserved inside the *Tattvopaplavasiṃha*.

Answer: B. The Bṛhaspati-sūtra is lost; about a dozen sūtras and verses survive only as quotations in other authors' works, so the correct form is "as transmitted in the sūtra quoted by later authors" or "on the standard reconstruction" - the content of pr̥thivyāptejovāyuriti tattvāni is well attested, but its textual status is not that of an available primary source.

Explanation:

47. The "ghee and debt" verse

A student opens an answer: "The Cārvāka scripture says: let a man live happily and feed on ghee even though he runs in debt." Which correction is required?

A. The verse comes from the *Sāmaññaphala-sutta*.

B. The verse is quoted from Vātsyāyana's *Kāma-sūtra*.

C. The verse is preserved in the **Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha**, Mādhava's fourteenth-century Vedāntic compendium - an **opponent's** summary written for refutation - and is not attributable to any surviving primary Cārvāka text; it should be presented as a **doxographical characterisation** of the school's spirit, and its buried argument (that deferral is irrational under a finite horizon) should be extracted rather than the slogan repeated.

D. The verse is a Jain parody with no relation to Cārvāka.

Answer: C. The verse is preserved in the Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha, Mādhava's fourteenth-century Vedāntic compendium - an opponent's summary written for refutation - and is not attributable to any surviving primary

Cārvāka text; it should be presented as a doxographical characterisation of the school's spirit, and its buried argument (that deferral is irrational under a finite horizon) should be extracted rather than the slogan repeated.

Explanation:

48. Jayarāṣi and the standard Cārvāka

A student writes: "Since Jayarāṣi shows that perception too is unreliable, the Cārvākas rejected all *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas)*." Which correction is required?

- A. Jayarāṣi accepts the four elements and differs from the standard Cārvāka only on ethics.
- B. Jayarāṣi was not a Cārvāka at all but a Buddhist.
- C. Jayarāṣi's work is lost and cannot be assessed.
- D. Jayarāṣi is described as a Cārvāka "of an **extreme type**" who "carries the scepticism of the ordinary Cārvāka to its logical conclusion by challenging the validity of **perceptual** knowledge and refusing to accept the existence of even the physical elements" - so his position is the tradition's internal **limit-case**, not its standard doctrine; the defining Cārvāka thesis remains that perception **alone** is a *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*, and using Jayarāṣi to state it destroys it.

Answer: D. Jayarāṣi is described as a Cārvāka "of an extreme type" who "carries the scepticism of the ordinary Cārvāka to its logical conclusion by challenging the validity of perceptual knowledge and refusing to accept the existence of even the physical elements" - so his position is the tradition's internal limit-case, not its standard doctrine; the defining Cārvāka thesis remains that perception alone is a means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa), and using Jayarāṣi to state it destroys it.

Explanation:

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

- 9 COMPLETE SOLUTIONS

2018 · Q8(b) · 15 marks

Question: Is Cārvāka rejection of inference acceptable to the other systems of Indian philosophy? If not, why? Do you think the views of other systems to be justified? Give reasons for your answer.

Practice status and source caution: This is an independent learner model, not an official UPSC key. Because the *Bṛhaspati-sūtra* is lost and the standard doctrine is reconstructed chiefly from hostile or refutational witnesses, doctrinal claims below are framed as the standard Cārvāka reconstruction; Jayarāṣi is used only as a contested sceptical limit-case, not as a simple representative of that standard position.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Three-limbed: a factual survey, an explanatory account, and an evaluative judgement in the candidate's own voice
Limb 1	Is it accepted? - a cross-school survey; the answer is overwhelmingly no
Limb 2	If not, why not? - the <i>reasons</i> , school by school, not a single generic reason
Limb 3	Are they justified? - the candidate's graded verdict, with reasons
Scope boundary	Stay on inference ; do not drift into Cārvāka ethics or the ritual polemic
Ideal thesis	The other systems are justified against the strong thesis, but the Cārvāka's residual point - that finite observation cannot entail an unrestricted universal - survives, and Nyāya concedes it by shifting from certainty to warrant
Non-negotiables	<i>Invariable concomitance (vyāpti)</i> ; the three doors; <i>hidden limiting condition (upādhi)</i> ; at least three named schools with their distinct reasons; the self-refutation charge; a criterion-named verdict

Independent model answer

The Cārvāka holds that *inference (anumāna)* is not a *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*, because *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)* cannot be secured: not by perception, since all cases past, present and future are never surveyed; not by inference, which yields a *petitio principii*; and not by testimony, whose own validity is inferred - and which, if it grounded inference, would mean "no one could infer anything by himself". *Hidden limiting condition (upādhi)* deepens this: the wet-fuel condition shows that unconditionality can never be perceptually certified.

No system accepts this. Nyāya replies that *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)* is built by *anvaya-vyatireka*, elimination of suspected *upādhis*, *hypothetical reasoning (tarka)* and *sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa*, and that *parāmarśa* - the mark cognised as qualified by concomitance - means no "leap" occurs. Sāṃkhya must reject it, since *primordial material nature (prakṛti)* and *conscious witness (puruṣa)* are established only inferentially. Mīmāṃsā must, since injunction and *apūrva* presuppose it. Buddhism, through Dignāga and Dharmakīrti, constructs an entire logic, and the *Tattvasaṅgraha* attacks Cārvāka's naïve perceptualism directly. Jainism needs inference for *matī* and *śruta*. Advaita alone partly agrees, but denies **ultimate** validity to perception as well - a level-distinction, as Sharma observes, "unknown to the Cārvāka".

Are they justified? Largely yes. The universal denial of inference is itself a universal; other minds and ideas are never perceived; Sharma is right that "the Cārvāka can understand others only through inference".

ANALYSIS: Verdict: they are justified against the strong thesis but not entitled to complacency, since Nyāya answers only by replacing omniscient certainty with disciplined warrant - a substitution that concedes the Cārvāka's logical point while denying his epistemological conclusion.

Depth refinement. The dispute is therefore not between reason and anti-reason. It concerns whether *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)* means indefeasible truth or responsibly corrigible warrant. Nyāya is strongest by the latter criterion; Cārvāka survives as a challenge to unrestricted universals.

Why this earns marks

- **Structure:** state the Cārvāka thesis with its argument -> survey the schools with **distinct** reasons -> the self-refutation charge -> the candidate's graded verdict. All three limbs must be visibly answered.
- **Doctrine:** *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)*, *hidden limiting condition (upādhi)*, *petitio principii*, *anvaya-vyatireka*, *hypothetical reasoning (tarka)*, *parāmarśa*, *sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa*.
- **Argument:** the three doors must appear as three, not as a vague "cannot be proved".
- **Distinction:** rejection of inference as *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)* versus rejection of practical inference - flag it, or the answer looks naïve.
- **Comparison:** at least four schools with school-specific reasons. A generic "all schools accept inference" earns half the marks.
- **Criticism:** self-refutation stated as steps, plus Sharma's point that thoughts and other minds are never perceived.

2019 · Q5(c) · 10 marks

Question: Are the Cārvākas consistent when they hold that inference is not a source of knowledge? Discuss.

Practice status and source caution: This is an independent learner model, not an official UPSC key. Because the *Bṛhaspati-sūtra* is lost and the standard doctrine is reconstructed chiefly from hostile or refutational witnesses, doctrinal claims below are framed as the standard Cārvāka reconstruction; Jayarāśi is used only as a contested sceptical limit-case, not as a simple representative of that standard position.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Discuss with an explicit verdict on consistency - a yes/no question that requires a qualified answer
Core issue	Whether the denial of inference can be stated and defended without using inference
Scope boundary	This is about internal coherence , not about whether inference is in fact valid

Element	Requirement
Ideal thesis	Inconsistent on the strong reading; consistent on the softened reading - but the softened reading is a much weaker doctrine
Non-negotiables	The charge reconstructed as steps; at least two of the three replies; the point that other minds and ideas are never perceived; a graded verdict

Independent model answer

The charge. The Cārvāka asserts that no inference is a valid source of knowledge. That assertion is a **universal**, quantifying over all inferential acts; no universal is given in any single perception. So it is either itself inferential - and self-defeating - or it fails its own standard. Sharma presses further: thoughts and ideas "cannot be perceived; they can only be inferred", so the Cārvāka "can understand others only through inference and make others understand him only through inference".

The replies. ANALYSIS: Three are available. (i) *Vitaṇḍā*: the Cārvāka advances no thesis, only destroys the opponent's claim to certainty - but he does assert four elements and a body-self, so this cannot be global. (ii) The **softened thesis**: he denies not inference itself but its capacity to yield **apodictic certainty**, especially about the transcendent. (iii) The **level-distinction**: concede *vyāvahārika* validity, deny the *pāramārthika* - though Sharma notes this distinction is "unknown to the Cārvāka".

ANALYSIS: **Verdict**: inconsistent as an unrestricted denial; consistent as a fallibilist warning. The Cārvāka may be **radical or consistent, but not both**.

Depth refinement. A practical concession needs an epistemic status: if successful worldly inference is knowledge, the absolute thesis contracts; if it is only expectation, Cārvāka must explain why rational action may trust what philosophy disqualifies.

Why this earns marks

- **Structure**: state the charge as numbered steps -> give the replies -> deliver the verdict. Do not narrate the *invariable concomitance* (*vyāpti*) argument at length; the question presupposes it.
- **Doctrine**: the exact form of the thesis being tested - "no inference is a *means of valid knowledge* (*pramāṇa*)" - and its universality.
- **Argument**: the step from "universal claim" to "not perceptually given" must be explicit.
- **Distinction**: *means of valid knowledge* (*pramāṇa*)-status versus practical usability; strong versus softened formulation.
- **Technical terms**: *vitaṇḍā*, *vyāvahārika* / *pāramārthika*, *means of valid knowledge* (*pramāṇa*).
- **Criticism**: the other-minds point is the sharpest form of the charge and is usually omitted.

2019 · Q6(c) · 15 marks

Question: What is wrong according to the Cārvākas with the following argument? All men are mortal. Socrates is a man. Therefore, Socrates is mortal. Justify your answer with arguments.

Practice status and source caution: This is an independent learner model, not an official UPSC key. Because the *Bṛhaspati-sūtra* is lost and the standard doctrine is reconstructed chiefly from hostile or refutational witnesses, doctrinal claims below are framed as the standard Cārvāka reconstruction; Jayarāśi is used only as a contested sceptical limit-case, not as a simple representative of that standard position.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Diagnose a specific argument, then justify the diagnosis - application, not recitation
Core issue	Whether the candidate attacks the right thing: the major premise , not the form
Scope boundary	Use the smoke-and-fire material only as illustration; the syllogism itself must stay in focus

Element	Requirement
Ideal thesis	The syllogism is valid but epistemically empty - it transmits a certainty in the major premise that was never independently acquired
Non-negotiables	Explicit refusal to attack validity; the major premise identified as <i>invariable concomitance (vyāpti)</i> ; the three doors applied to "All men are mortal"; <i>petitio principii</i> ; <i>hidden limiting condition (upādhi)</i> ; one line of self-critical balance

Independent model answer

The Cārvāka objection is **not** that the argument is formally invalid. If the premises hold, the conclusion follows; the Cārvāka concedes this and attacks elsewhere.

The target is the **major premise**, "All men are mortal", which functions exactly as *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)* does in Indian inference: an invariable, exceptionless concomitance between man-ness and mortality. How is such a universal known?

Not by perception. No one has perceived all men. Chatterjee and Datta press the point: we cannot perceive even all present cases, "to speak nothing of those which existed in the past or will exist in the future." Nor does relocating the relation among class-characters help: "it is not possible even to know by perception what 'smokeness' ... is, because we do not perceive all cases of smoke", and a relation between universals does not license an inference about **this** particular.

Not by inference. Establishing the universal inferentially requires a further universal - *petitio principii*, or an endless regress.

Not by testimony. Testimony's validity is itself inferred; and if inference depended on testimony, "no one could infer anything by himself."

Hence, in Sharma's formulation, the syllogism is an **argument in a circle**: the conclusion "Socrates is mortal" is already contained in "All men are mortal". Deduction merely extracts what induction never established. *Hidden limiting condition (upādhi)* deepens the charge: perhaps what is genuinely invariable is not man-ness with mortality but organic embodiment under conditions never fully surveyed.

ANALYSIS: **Verdict:** the syllogism is valid but epistemically empty. The charge is a serious one about induction - though the Cārvāka must still explain how his own universal denial of inference is known.

Depth refinement. This diagnosis anticipates the problem of induction without making Cārvāka a modern empiricist. Its precise claim is not that deduction fails formally, but that deduction cannot manufacture warrant absent from its universal premise.

Why this earns marks

- **Structure:** disclaim the attack on validity -> identify the major premise as *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)* -> run the three doors **on this premise** -> *petitio principii* -> *hidden limiting condition (upādhi)* -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)*, *sāmānya* / class-character, *hidden limiting condition (upādhi)*, *petitio principii*.
- **Argument:** the three doors must be applied to "All men are mortal" specifically, not narrated abstractly about smoke.
- **Distinction:** validity versus soundness; deduction's circularity versus induction's insecurity, and the fact that each is cured only by the other.
- **Technical terms:** major premise as *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)*; *sādhya* and *hetu*; *inference (anumāna)* and *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*.
- **Comparison:** one line noting that Nyāya would answer with *anvaya-vyatireka*, *hypothetical reasoning (tarka)* and *parāmarśa*.

2020 · Q6(b) · 15 marks

Question: Critically evaluate Cārvākas' rejection of Ākāśa as one of the elements of reality and examine their criticism of transmigration of Soul.

Practice status and source caution: This is an independent learner model, not an official UPSC key. Because the *Bṛhaspati-sūtra* is lost and the standard doctrine is reconstructed chiefly from hostile or refutational witnesses, doctrinal claims below are framed as the standard Cārvāka reconstruction; Jayarāśi is used only as a contested sceptical limit-case, not as a simple representative of that standard position.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Critically evaluate and examine</i> - two tasks, both requiring two-sided assessment
Core issue	That both rejections are the same argument applied twice , once to cosmology and once to soteriology
Scope boundary	Two halves, roughly balanced; do not let <i>ākāśa</i> consume the answer
Ideal thesis	The rejections are impeccably consistent with the epistemology, and are therefore exactly as strong - and as vulnerable - as that epistemology
Non-negotiables	The Vaiśeṣika sound-to- <i>ākāśa</i> inference named and refused; the four requirements of transmigration each cut; at least two objections with replies; a criterion-named verdict

Independent model answer

Ākāśa. FACT: Most Indian schools admit five elements; Cārvāka admits four - earth, water, fire and air. The reason is exact: *ākāśa* "is not perceived but **inferred**" (Sharma). The Vaiśeṣika reaches it by argument - sound is a quality; qualities inhere in substances; sound belongs to no other admitted substance; therefore *ākāśa* exists as its substrate. Since inference is not a *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*, that route is closed.

ANALYSIS: Critical evaluation. The rejection is consistent and economical, and it correctly identifies that *ākāśa* is a **theoretical posit**, not a datum. But it carries a cost: the Cārvāka accepts the four elements *as substances*, so he cannot refuse the substance-quality scheme for sound alone without argument. His strongest line is therefore to naturalise sound as a modification of perceptible air - a naturalising rather than a merely sceptical move.

Transmigration. FACT: Transmigration requires (a) a self distinct from the body, (b) its survival after death, (c) a carrier of moral desert, and (d) knowledge that these obtain. Cārvāka cuts each: *conscious body as self (dehātmanvāda)* makes the self the living body - *caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ*; "death of the body means the end of the individual"; *action and moral consequence (karma)* and *adrṣṭa* are unperceived; and only scripture or inference could supply the knowledge.

ANALYSIS: Examination. Strengths: consistency, economy, and the exposure of unfalsifiable postulates.

Weaknesses: Sharma shows that dependence is not production - "the eye cannot see in darkness ... yet light cannot be regarded as the cause of sight"; the argument slides from "unestablished" to "unreal"; and, as Sharma adds, the soul's non-existence "too cannot be demonstrated".

ANALYSIS: Verdict: one epistemic cut, applied twice - and its force is exactly the force of that cut.

Depth refinement. The burden of proof remains crucial: Cārvāka may show that the opponent has not established *ākāśa* or transmigration, but the stronger claim of non-existence needs a bridge from epistemic absence to ontological absence.

Why this earns marks

- **Structure:** two clearly signposted halves, each with exposition and evaluation; a unifying final sentence.
- **Doctrine:** four *bhūtas*; the Vaiśeṣika sound-substrate inference; *conscious body as self (dehātmanvāda)*; *adrṣṭa*.
- **Argument:** the four requirements of transmigration, each explicitly cut.
- **Distinction:** rejecting *ākāśa* as an entity versus denying that sound is heard; "unestablished" versus "unreal".
- **Technical terms:** *ākāśa*, *bhūta*, *adrṣṭa*, *caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ*, *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*.
- **Criticism:** at least two - the instrument objection and the unestablished/unreal slide; ideally Sharma's symmetry point too.

2020 · Q7(c) · 15 marks

Question: Explain the differences of conception of Reality between Cārvāka and Jainism.

Practice status and source caution: This is an independent learner model, not an official UPSC key. Because the *Bṛhaspati-sūtra* is lost and the standard doctrine is reconstructed chiefly from hostile or refutational witnesses, doctrinal claims below are framed as the standard Cārvāka reconstruction; Jayarāśi is used only as a contested sceptical limit-case, not as a simple representative of that standard position.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Explain the differences</i> - a sustained axis-by-axis comparison, not two mini-essays
Core issue	Conceptions of reality : what exists, how it is known, and how change and persistence are accommodated
Scope boundary	Metaphysics and its epistemology; ethics only if it illuminates the ontology
Ideal thesis	The deepest difference is not materialism versus spiritualism but the number of standpoints each admits - Jainism multiplies both entities and viewpoints; Cārvāka admits one of each
Non-negotiables	<i>Means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas)</i> ; the definition of <i>sat</i> ; four <i>bhūtas</i> versus six <i>dravyas</i> ; <i>ākāśa</i> ; soul and consciousness; <i>anekāntavāda</i> and <i>syādvāda</i> ; action and moral consequence (karma); liberation; and the shared <i>Veda-rejecting school (nāstika)</i> ground

Independent model answer

Epistemic root. FACT: Cārvāka admits one *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*, *perception (pratyakṣa)*. Jainism admits a fivefold knowledge - *mati*, *śruta*, *avadhi*, *manaḥparyāya*, *kevala* - and hence inference. Every later divergence follows from this.

Definition of the real. FACT: For Jainism, *sat* is **utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya** - origination, decay and persistence together; the gold that becomes bracelet and then ring persists as *dravya* while its *paryāyas* change. Cārvāka has no such analysis: elements are eternal, combinations transient, and that is all.

Constituents. FACT: Four *bhūtas* for Cārvāka; **six dravyas** for Jainism - *individual self (jīva)*, *pudgala*, *dharma*, *adharma*, *ākāśa*, *kāla*. *Ākāśa* is rejected by the Cārvāka as inferred; for Jainism it is a distinct substance providing accommodation.

Soul and consciousness. FACT: Cārvāka: no *individual self (jīva)*; the self is the living body, and consciousness an emergent by-product. Jainism: infinitely many *individual self (jīvas)*, with consciousness their **inseparable essence** - expressly denying, as the sources put it, the Cārvāka view that it is "a mere accidental property, arising only under some conditions".

Standpoint. FACT: Jainism's **anekāntavāda**, with *nayavāda* and *syādvāda*, holds reality many-faced and every judgement conditioned. Cārvāka admits a single standpoint and no level-distinction at all.

Action and moral consequence (karma) and liberation. FACT: Jainism: action and moral consequence (karma) as **subtle matter** adhering to the *individual self (jīva)*, *bhāvabandha* and *dravyabandha*, with *liberation (mokṣa)* through the three jewels and *kevala-jñāna*. Cārvāka: no action and moral consequence (karma), and *marāṇam eva apavargaḥ*.

ANALYSIS: **Verdict.** Their agreement is instructive: both are *Veda-rejecting school (nāstika)*, both realists about the perceptible world, both reject a creator. The divergence is over standpoints and substances - which is why Jainism can hold change and persistence together while Cārvāka can only assert them side by side.

Depth refinement. Jainism buys explanatory articulation through ontological plurality; Cārvāka buys economy through restriction. Jainism therefore wins on change-and-persistence, while Cārvāka preserves the question of evidential cost.

Why this earns marks

- **Structure:** named axes, each carrying both positions in the same sentence or row; then the unifying thesis; then the shared ground.
- **Doctrine:** *utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya*; six *dravyas*; *constituent quality (guṇa)* and *paryāya*; *anekānta*, *naya*, *syādvāda*; four *bhūtas*.

- **Argument:** show that the metaphysical divergence is *generated* by the epistemic divergence.
- **Distinction:** Jaina *dharma* and *adharma* are **media of motion and rest**, not merit and demerit - a classic trap.
- **Technical terms:** *sat*, *dravya*, *individual self (jīva)*, *pudgala*, *bhūta*, *kevala-jñāna*, *bhāvabandha* and *dravyabandha*.
- **Comparison:** at least seven axes; fewer looks thin at 15 marks.

2021 · Q5(e) · 10 marks

Question: Comment on the bearing of Cārvāka epistemology on the rejection of transcendental entities by them.

Practice status and source caution: This is an independent learner model, not an official UPSC key. Because the *Bṛhaspati-sūtra* is lost and the standard doctrine is reconstructed chiefly from hostile or refutational witnesses, doctrinal claims below are framed as the standard Cārvāka reconstruction; Jayarāśi is used only as a contested sceptical limit-case, not as a simple representative of that standard position.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Comment on the bearing</i> - the examiner wants the derivation , not two lists
Core issue	That a single epistemic premise severs every transcendent entity at once
Scope boundary	Do not narrate the <i>invariable concomitance (vyāpti)</i> argument at length; compress it and spend the words on the derivation
Ideal thesis	Cārvāka ontology is the exact ontological shadow of its epistemology, so the denials are consequences and not separate acts of unbelief
Non-negotiables	The compressed epistemic argument; the bridging principle named as a presupposition; at least five entities derived; one line of evaluation

Independent model answer

For Cārvāka, ontology is the shadow cast by epistemology. Perception alone is a *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*: *inference (anumāna)* fails because *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)* is established neither by perception (all cases are never surveyed), nor by inference (*petitio principii*), nor by testimony (whose own validity is inferred); *verbal testimony (śabda)* fails because words certify only that something was said. Chatterjee and Datta accordingly state that the Cārvāka theory of reality **"follows from"** this epistemological conclusion.

The **bearing** is systematic. The bridging principle - ontological commitment must not outrun the accepted *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas)* - is then applied without exception. *Ākāśa* falls, being inferred from sound. *Enduring self (ātman)* falls, never being perceived apart from the living body. *Lord (Īśvara)* falls, being reached only by design-inference while *svabhāva* discharges the explanatory work. *Action and moral consequence (karma)*, *adṛṣṭa*, rebirth, *svarga* and *liberation (mokṣa)* fall as unseen forces or post-mortem states no perception could present. Vedic authority falls with *verbal testimony (śabda)*, and ritual loses its rationale with it.

ANALYSIS: Comment: the derivation is impeccably consistent; its cost is that the whole ontology stands or falls with the rejection of inference.

Depth refinement. The denials are not object-level duplicates: some reject theoretical substrates, some moral mechanisms, and some authoritative testimony. Their unity lies in one evidential filter rather than one identical argument.

Why this earns marks

- **Structure:** epistemology compressed into one paragraph -> the bridging principle -> the derivation, entity by entity -> one evaluative line.
- **Doctrine:** *pratyakṣaika-pramāṇavāda*; the bridging principle; *explanation through natural properties (svabhāvavāda)*.
- **Argument:** the derivation must read as a *consequence*, with connectives such as "hence", "therefore", "with it".

- **Distinction:** the bridging principle is a **presupposition**, not a theorem - an opponent could accept the epistemology and still hold that reality exceeds knowledge.
- **Technical terms:** *ākāśa*, *enduring self (ātman)*, *Lord (Īśvara)*, *action and moral consequence (karma)*, *adṛṣṭa*, *svarga*, *liberation (mokṣa)*, *verbal testimony (śabda)*.
- **Comparison:** if space allows, one clause noting that Sāṃkhya and Mīmāṃsā are also non-theistic but keep *action and moral consequence (karma)* and rebirth, because their epistemology admits inference.

2024 · Q5(a) · 10 marks

Question: Do you think Cārvāka's philosophy is positivistic in nature? Give reasons and justifications for your answer.

Practice status and source caution: This is an independent learner model, not an official UPSC key. Because the *Bṛhaspati-sūtra* is lost and the standard doctrine is reconstructed chiefly from hostile or refutational witnesses, doctrinal claims below are framed as the standard Cārvāka reconstruction; Jayarāśi is used only as a contested sceptical limit-case, not as a simple representative of that standard position.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	An explicit personal verdict with reasons and justifications - a graded answer, never a flat yes or no
Core issue	Whether an empiricist criterion and anti-metaphysical temper suffice for the label, given that Cārvāka rejects inference
Scope boundary	Comparative epistemology and method; do not turn it into a history of logical positivism
Ideal thesis	Positivistic in spirit , not in method ; "radical empiricism" is the safer label
Non-negotiables	The evidential point that the textbooks themselves apply the word; at least three points for and three against; the inference divergence; a named alternative label

Independent model answer

ANALYSIS: Yes in spirit, no in method.

The case for. FACT: The label is not imported by the examiner: Chatterjee and Datta write that the Cārvāka theory "may also be called **positivism**, because it believes only in **positive facts or observable phenomena**", and compare its view of inference to that of "the pragmatists and logical positivists". Cārvāka restricts the knowable to what perception presents; rejects God, soul, *action and moral consequence (karma)* and heaven as unwarranted; refuses scriptural authority; grounds value in this-worldly pleasure and pain; and even adopts a quasi-verificationist register, since questions about rebirth and heaven are said to become "**meaningless**".

The case against. ANALYSIS: Positivism is built on **inference** - science is systematised inference - which Cārvāka denies *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*-status. Positivism admits unobservables that earn their explanatory keep; Cārvāka refuses them. Positivism offers a constructive programme with formal and semantic tools; Cārvāka offers a polemical minimalism. Comte's law of three stages and sociology have no Indian counterpart.

ANALYSIS: Verdict: an illuminating analogy, not a historical identity. **Radical empiricism** or **naturalistic materialism** is the more accurate description. The paradox is that Cārvāka reaches a materialist conclusion by an **anti-inferential** route.

Depth refinement. The comparison is heuristic, not genealogical. Cārvāka resembles positivism in policing metaphysical admission but differs because its anti-inferentialism weakens the law-governed science that later positivisms elevate.

Why this earns marks

- **Structure:** verdict first -> case for -> case against -> refined label. A graded verdict announced early controls the whole answer.
- **Doctrine:** the textbook's own use of the word "positivism", with its stated reason - this is the strongest single evidential move available.
- **Argument:** the inference divergence must be identified as the **decisive** disanalogy, not listed among equals.

- **Distinction:** spirit versus method; empiricism versus positivism; verificationism versus mere anti-metaphysics.
- **Technical terms:** *perception (pratyakṣa)*, *inference (anumāna)*, *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*, *explanation through natural properties (svabhāvavāda)*, verification, unobservables.
- **Comparison:** at least one named Western reference point - Comte or Ayer - used precisely.

2024 · Q6(a) · 20 marks

Question: Differentiate between the Cārvākas' refutation of self as a transcendental category and the Buddhist rejection of ātmā.

Practice status and source caution: This is an independent learner model, not an official UPSC key. Because the *Bṛhaspati-sūtra* is lost and the standard doctrine is reconstructed chiefly from hostile or refutational witnesses, doctrinal claims below are framed as the standard Cārvāka reconstruction; Jayarāṣi is used only as a contested sceptical limit-case, not as a simple representative of that standard position.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Differentiate</i> - sustained contrast on named axes; separate descriptions will not do
Core issue	That two denials of <i>enduring self (ātman)</i> can be philosophically opposite in target, ground, aftermath and metaphysical price
Scope boundary	The self; bring in action and moral consequence (karma), rebirth and liberation only as consequences of the two denials
Ideal thesis	Cārvāka relocates the self into matter; Buddhism dissolves it into process. Substance retained versus substance abolished
Non-negotiables	<i>Conscious body as self (dehātmavāda)</i> with its formula; the five <i>skandhas</i> ; <i>santāna</i> ; the epistemic versus ontological-soteriological grounds; the point that <i>rūpa</i> is itself a <i>skandha</i> ; the divergent aftermaths

Independent model answer

Both schools reject the *enduring self (ātman)* of Nyāya and Vedānta, but the rejections are not species of one genus.

Cārvāka: relocation. FACT: The doctrine is *conscious body as self (dehātmavāda)* - *caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ*, the person is the body qualified by consciousness. The **ground is epistemological**: perception alone is a *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*, and "the non-material soul is never perceived". The positive argument is drawn from ordinary speech: we say "I am fat", "I am lame", "I am blind", and if the "I" were distinct from the body these would be meaningless. Consciousness is admitted, but as an **emergent by-product** of the organised elements - as the betel leaf, lime and nut together yield a redness none possesses, and as molasses becomes intoxicant on fermenting. Since no self survives the body's dissolution, "death of the body means the end of the individual"; *action and moral consequence (karma)*, rebirth, *svarga* and *liberation (mokṣa)* all lapse, and *maraṇam eva apavargaḥ*.

Buddhism: dissolution. FACT: *Anātman* denies not the transcendence but the **substantiality** of the self. The person is analysed into five *skandhas* - *rūpa*, *vedanā*, *saṃjñā*, *saṃskāra*, *vijñāna* - with no owner behind them; "chariot" names an arrangement of parts, and so does "person". The **ground is ontological and soteriological**: *pratītyasamutpāda* and *kṣaṇikavāda* leave no room for a permanent entity, and belief in a self generates craving and suffering. Continuity is preserved by *santāna*, the causal stream, with *pratisandhāna* and, in Yogācāra, *ālaya-vijñāna* bearing *bījas*. Hence action and moral consequence (karma) and rebirth survive **without** a self, and *cessation of conditioned suffering (nirvāṇa)* remains the goal.

ANALYSIS: The four differentiating theses. (i) **Targets** differ: Cārvāka substitutes a material self, whereas Buddhism denies substantiality of any kind - and since *rūpa* is itself one of the *skandhas*, Buddhist analysis refutes the Cārvāka body-self **by name**. (ii) **Grounds** differ: epistemic versus ontological-soteriological. (iii) **Aftermaths** differ: Cārvāka terminates the moral narrative at death; Buddhism is engineered precisely to continue it. (iv) **Prices** differ: Cārvāka must explain how matter yields subjectivity; Buddhism must explain how an ownerless stream yields memory, desert and liberation.

ANALYSIS: Verdict: Cārvāka denies the self's **transcendence** while retaining its **substantiality**; Buddhism denies its substantiality while retaining its **moral continuity**.

Depth refinement. Both views face continuity problems of different kinds: Cārvāka must explain identity through bodily change without a separate subject; Buddhism must explain responsibility across an ownerless causal series. This symmetry prevents a one-sided comparison.

Why this earns marks

- **Structure:** the two positions stated compactly -> four explicit differentiating theses -> a one-line verdict. Do not write two biographies.
- **Doctrine:** *conscious body as self (dehātmavāda)* with the Sanskrit formula; the five *skandhas* named in order; *santāna*; *pratītyasamutpāda* and *kṣaṇikavāda*.
- **Argument:** the "I am fat / lame / blind" argument, and the chariot analogy, both reproduced.
- **Distinction:** transcendence versus substantiality - this single distinction carries the whole answer.
- **Technical terms:** *caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ*, *anātman / nairātmyavāda*, *pudgala-nairātmya*, *ālaya-vijñāna*, *bīja*.
- **Criticism:** the point that *rūpa* is itself a *skandha*, so Buddhism rules out the Cārvāka self explicitly - very few candidates make it.

2025 · Q5(a) · 10 marks

Question: Explain the ground on which Cārvāka rejects inference as a valid source of knowledge.

Practice status and source caution: This is an independent learner model, not an official UPSC key. Because the *Bṛhaspati-sūtra* is lost and the standard doctrine is reconstructed chiefly from hostile or refutational witnesses, doctrinal claims below are framed as the standard Cārvāka reconstruction; Jayarāśi is used only as a contested sceptical limit-case, not as a simple representative of that standard position.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Explain the ground</i> - a focused, architecturally clean exposition; evaluation is secondary
Core issue	The impossibility of establishing <i>invariable concomitance (vyāpti)</i>
Scope boundary	Stay on the ground for rejection; do not survey the other schools' replies at length
Ideal thesis	The ground is that <i>invariable concomitance (vyāpti)</i> , without which inference cannot claim certainty, is unobtainable by any means the Cārvāka admits
Non-negotiables	<i>Invariable concomitance (vyāpti)</i> defined; the three doors; <i>hidden limiting condition (upādhi)</i> ; the "accident and separable" line; one closing sentence of balance

Independent model answer

FACT: The ground is the **impossibility of establishing invariable concomitance (vyāpti)**. Inference moves from a perceived mark to an unperceived *sādhya*, and is licensed only by an invariable concomitance - "wherever smoke, there fire". For inference to be a *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*, that universal must be beyond doubt.

It cannot be had by perception: we cannot perceive all cases of smoke and fire even now, "to speak nothing of those which existed in the past or will exist in the future"; and the retreat to class-characters fails, since "smokeness" itself is not perceptually known while all instances are not perceived.

Nor by inference: that would be a *petitio principii*, since the further inference needs its own *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)*.

Nor by testimony: testimony's own validity is inferred; and if inference depended on it, "no one could infer anything by himself."

Hidden limiting condition (upādhi) completes the case: fire yields smoke only where fuel is wet, and hidden conditions "may always remain hidden and escape notice", so unconditionality is never certified.

ANALYSIS: Hence truth is "only an **accident**, and a **separable** one" in inference - not the guaranteed character a *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)* requires.

Depth refinement. The strongest soft reading permits corrigible, perception-redeemable practical expectation. It protects ordinary life but transforms the dispute into one about certainty, scope and transcendental overreach.

Why this earns marks

- **Structure:** define *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)* -> three doors -> *hidden limiting condition (upādhi)* -> the "accident and separable" conclusion. Clean, fast, complete.
- **Doctrine:** *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)*, *liṅga* and *sādhya*, *hidden limiting condition (upādhi)*, *petitio principii*.
- **Argument:** the three doors must be visibly three; a vague "it cannot be proved" earns little.
- **Distinction:** rejection as *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)* versus everyday expectation - one clause is enough, but it must be there.
- **Technical terms:** at least four Sanskrit terms, each glossed on first use.
- **Comparison:** at most one clause on Nyāya's reply; the question does not ask for it.

These six questions are original practice prompts, not UPSC PYQs. Each model is written independently for learner use.

Original 1 · 10 marks

Question: Explain why the Cārvāka rejects *verbal testimony (śabda)* as an independent *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*, and assess whether the rejection is consistent with his acceptance of perception. **(10 marks, ~150 words)**

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Explain</i> then <i>assess</i> - exposition plus a consistency verdict
Core issue	Whether admitting words-as-sounds while refusing words-as-evidence is coherent
Ideal thesis	The rejection is internally consistent, since the perceived item is the sound and the disputed item is the content

Full independent model answer

FACT: The Cārvāka argument runs in steps. Words heard through the ears are **perceived**, so knowledge of words is perceptual and valid. But insofar as words "suggest or mean things not within our perception", they "are not free from error and doubt". Acceptance of an authority proceeds through a suppressed inference - "this authority is reliable; all reliable authority should be accepted" - and, being based on inference, testimony is "as precarious as inference". In the special case of the Veda, claims of authority cannot be perceptually certified, and Chatterjee and Datta report the Cārvāka's charge that the texts are "the works of some cunning priests".

ANALYSIS: **Assessment.** The rejection is consistent, because the Cārvāka carefully separates two objects: the **sound**, which is perceived, and the **content**, which is not. He therefore denies testimony independent *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*-status without denying communication. The residual cost is that a life without testimonial knowledge is unliveable - but that is a charge of impracticality, not of inconsistency.

Why this earns marks

- The five-step argument reproduced, not merely summarised.
- The sound/content distinction stated explicitly - this is what secures consistency.
- The suppressed reliability premise identified as an **inference**.
- One line on the Veda, framed epistemically rather than as abuse.
- A verdict that distinguishes **inconsistency** from **impracticality**.

Original 2 · 10 marks

Question: Distinguish *explanation through natural properties (svabhāvavāda)* from *yadr̥cchāvāda* in Cārvāka metaphysics and examine whether they are consistent. **(10 marks, ~150 words)**

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Distinguish</i> then <i>examine</i> consistency - a conceptual distinction put to critical work
Core issue	Whether fixed natures and fortuitous combination can both be asserted
Ideal thesis	They are compatible only if <i>svabhāva</i> governs the behaviour of elements while <i>yadṛcchā</i> governs their initial concurrence ; otherwise there is tension

Full independent model answer

FACT: **Explanation through natural properties (svabhāvavāda)** is naturalism: "the material elements themselves have got each its fixed nature (*svabhāva*)", and it is by these inherent natures and laws that they combine, so "there is thus no necessity for God"; fire is hot and water cool by their own natures. FACT: **Yadṛcchāvāda** is mechanism or accidentalism: it "denies the existence of conscious purpose behind the world" and explains it "as a mere mechanical or **fortuitous** combination of elements".

ANALYSIS: **Examination.** There is a real tension. If the elements combine **by their fixed natures**, the resulting world is lawful and not fortuitous; if the combination is **fortuitous**, natures cannot be doing the explanatory work. The most charitable reconstruction assigns them different roles: *svabhāva* explains how each element **behaves** once in combination, while *yadṛcchā* denies that any **purpose** governs which combinations occur. On that reading they are consistent, and their joint target is teleology rather than regularity. ANALYSIS: The Cārvāka's own caution supports this: he grants that there is "neither any guarantee that uniformity perceived in the past would continue in future".

Why this earns marks

- Both terms defined with the textbook's own glosses.
- The tension named explicitly rather than glossed over.
- A charitable reconstruction offered, with its division of labour.
- The "no guarantee of future uniformity" line used as evidence for the deflationary reading.
- A verdict that identifies **teleology**, not regularity, as the common target.

Original 3 · 15 marks

Question: Examine the Cārvāka doctrine that consciousness is an emergent by-product of the four elements, with the objections it faces. (15 marks, ~230 words)

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Examine ... with the objections</i> - exposition plus a serious objection set and replies
Core issue	Whether the emergence analogies establish emergence of the right logical type
Ideal thesis	The analogies establish that novel public qualities emerge; consciousness is private and first-personal, so the explanatory gap remains - though dualism does not close it either

Full independent model answer

FACT: **The doctrine.** *Kiṇvāḍibhyo madaśaktivad vijñānam*: consciousness arises from matter as intoxicating power arises from fermenting agents. The objection it answers is stated by Chatterjee and Datta: "we do not perceive consciousness in any of the four material elements. How can it then come to qualify their product, the body?" The reply uses two analogies with distinct functions. **Betel** - leaf, lime and nut, "none of which is originally red", yielding a reddish tinge when chewed together - establishes **compositional** emergence. **Fermentation** - molasses, "originally non-intoxicant", becoming intoxicant when allowed to ferment - establishes **transformational** emergence. Consciousness is accordingly "an **epiphenomenon** or by-product of matter".

ANALYSIS: **Objections.** (i) The analogies concern **public, third-person** qualities; consciousness is **private** - Sharma notes it "is neither smelt nor tasted nor seen nor touched nor heard", and "consciousness of an individual cannot be shared by others". (ii) In swoon, epilepsy and dreamless sleep the living body persists **without** consciousness, so the property is not inseparable. (iii) Constant co-occurrence is not causation: "the eye cannot see in darkness ... yet light cannot be regarded as the cause of sight", and the two horns of a bull are conjoined without being causally related - so

the body may be the **instrument** of consciousness rather than its cause.

ANALYSIS: **Replies and verdict.** The Cārvāka may answer that the property is essential to a specific **organisation** rather than to bare bodily existence, and that positing an immaterial soul merely **renames** the gap. The honest verdict: the evidence establishes **dependence**, not production; both sides face the gap, and only one claims to have crossed it.

Why this earns marks

- The transmitted *sūtra* quoted or paraphrased.
- Both analogies, with their **distinct** functions named.
- The word *epiphenomenon* used precisely.
- At least three objections, at least two of them from the standard battery.
- The Cārvāka's replies given before the verdict.
- A verdict distinguishing **dependence** from **production**.

Original 4 · 15 marks

Question: "The Cārvāka's *hidden limiting condition* (*upādhi*) objection is a stronger argument than his objection from incomplete enumeration." Critically discuss. (15 marks, ~230 words)

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Critically discuss</i> an evaluative comparison between two of the Cārvāka's own arguments
Core issue	Sample size versus identification of the relevant variable
Ideal thesis	The claim is correct: enumeration is curable in principle by more observation, whereas <i>hidden limiting condition</i> (<i>upādhi</i>) is not

Full independent model answer

FACT: **The enumeration objection.** *Invariable concomitance* (*vyāpti*) requires knowledge of all cases, and "we cannot perceive even all the cases of smoke and fire existing now ... to speak nothing of those which existed in the past or will exist in the future".

FACT: **The hidden limiting condition (*upādhi*) objection.** Even where two things are repeatedly observed together, an unnoticed condition may be operating. One who has often seen fire accompanied by smoke may infer smoke from fire and err, having failed to notice the *hidden limiting condition* (*upādhi*) of **wetness of fuel**, on whose presence alone fire is attended with smoke. Hence "so long as the relation between two phenomena is not proved to be **unconditional**, it is an uncertain ground for inference" - and unconditionality "cannot be established beyond doubt by perception, as some conditions may **always remain hidden**".

ANALYSIS: **Why the second is stronger.** Enumeration is a defect of **quantity**: more observation improves the position, even if it never completes it. *Hidden limiting condition* (*upādhi*) is a defect of **identification**: it concerns whether the property picked out is the genuine ground of the relation, and no amount of further counting settles it. The proof is dialectical - Nyāya answers enumeration with *bhūyodarśana* and the joint method of co-presence and co-absence, but must bring in **hypothetical reasoning** (*tarka*) and *sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa* to address *hidden limiting condition* (*upādhi*), and concedes that only **suspected** conditions can be eliminated.

ANALYSIS: **Counter-consideration and verdict.** Nyāya may reply that a relation surviving systematic negative-case testing plus *hypothetical reasoning* (*tarka*) is rationally warranted even if not indefeasible. That defends inference; it does not refute the *hidden limiting condition* (*upādhi*) point. The claim therefore stands: *hidden limiting condition* (*upādhi*) is the deeper argument, and it is the one that forces Nyāya to change the standard from certainty to warrant.

Why this earns marks

- Both objections stated accurately, with the *hidden limiting condition* (*upādhi*) example running **fire -> smoke**.
- The quantity/identification distinction stated as the pivot of the answer.
- The dialectical proof: Nyāya's differential response to the two objections.

- *Hypothetical reasoning (tarka)* correctly described as an auxiliary, not a *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*.
- A verdict that concedes Nyāya's warrant-based defence while upholding the comparison.

Original 5 · 20 marks

Question: "Cārvāka's metaphysics is nothing but its epistemology written out as a list of denials." Critically evaluate. (20 marks, ~340 words)

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Critically evaluate</i> a strong interpretive claim - say how far it is true and where it fails
Core issue	Whether the metaphysics is wholly derivative or contains independent positive commitments
Ideal thesis	Largely true of the denials , false of the affirmations - the four elements, emergence and <i>svabhāva</i> are positive theses not entailed by the epistemology alone

Full independent model answer

FACT: The case for the claim. Chatterjee and Datta state that the Cārvāka theory of reality "**follows from**" the epistemological conclusion: if perception is the only reliable source of knowledge, "we can rationally assert only the reality of perceptible objects. God, soul, heaven, life before birth or after death, and any unperceived law (like *adṛṣṭa*) cannot be believed in, because they are all beyond perception."

The derivation is exact. *Ākāśa* falls because it is inferred from sound. *Enduring self (ātman)* falls because no soul is perceived apart from the living body. *Lord (Īśvara)* falls because he is reached only by design-inference. *Action and moral consequence (karma)*, *adṛṣṭa*, rebirth, *svarga* and *liberation (mokṣa)* fall as unseen forces or post-mortem states. Vedic authority falls with *verbal testimony (śabda)*, and ritual with it. One cut, seven casualties.

ANALYSIS: Where the claim fails. Three points. (i) The derivation needs a **bridging principle** - that ontological commitment must not outrun the accepted *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas)* - which is a **presupposition**, not a theorem. An opponent could accept the epistemology and hold that reality exceeds knowledge; the Cārvāka's refusal of that gap is a substantive metaphysical decision.

(ii) The metaphysics contains **positive** theses the epistemology does not yield. That there are exactly **four** elements, that they are **eternal** while their combinations perish, that consciousness **emerges** from organised matter as redness emerges from betel and intoxication from fermented molasses, and that *svabhāva* explains regularity - none of these is entailed by "only perception is a *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*". They are empirical and explanatory hypotheses.

(iii) There is even an internal strain among them: *explanation through natural properties (svabhāvavāda)* grounds regularity in fixed natures while *yadṛcchāvāda* calls the world's objects "fortuitous products". A purely derivative metaphysics could not generate such a tension.

ANALYSIS: Verdict. The claim is **true of the negative half and false of the positive half**. Cārvāka's denials are indeed epistemology written out as a list - which is why they stand or fall entirely with the rejection of inference. But its affirmations are a materialist research programme in miniature, and they carry explanatory burdens of their own: chiefly the explanatory gap between public emergent qualities and private consciousness, which no epistemic restriction can discharge. **ANALYSIS: Criterion named: derivational economy** supports the claim, **explanatory content** refutes it.

Why this earns marks

- The derivation reproduced compactly, with connectives.
- The bridging principle named as a **presupposition**.
- At least three positive theses identified as underivable from the epistemology.
- The internal *svabhāva* / *yadṛcchā* tension used as evidence.
- A split verdict - true of the denials, false of the affirmations - with a named criterion.

Original 6 · 20 marks

Question: Compare the Cārvāka and Nyāya positions on *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)*, and assess whether Nyāya successfully answers the Cārvāka. (20 marks, ~340 words)

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Compare then assess success - the assessment must name a standard of success
Core issue	Whether replacing certainty with warrant answers the objection or changes the subject
Ideal thesis	Nyāya succeeds against the practical challenge and concedes the logical point; the dispute is ultimately about the concept of knowledge

Full independent model answer

FACT: **Cārvāka.** *Invariable concomitance (vyāpti)* is required for inference to claim certainty, and it can be had from no admitted source. Not from perception: all cases past, present and future are never surveyed, and the retreat to class-characters fails, since "smokeness" itself is not perceptually known. Not from inference: *petitio principii* or regress; deduction is circular and induction unwarranted. Not from testimony: its own validity is inferred, and if inference depended on it "no one could infer anything by himself". *Hidden limiting condition (upādhi)* completes the case, since unconditionality cannot be certified while hidden conditions "may always remain hidden and escape notice".

FACT: **Nyāya.** *Invariable concomitance (vyāpti)* is **assembled**, not intuited in one act. Repeated observation (*bhūyodarśana*) is disciplined as **agreement in presence (anvaya)** (co-presence) and **agreement in absence (vyatireka)** (co-absence), making it a structured search for counter-instances. Suspected *upādhis* are identified and the universal restated at the correct level - "fire joined with wet fuel, there smoke". **Hypothetical reasoning (tarka)** - not a *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)* but a *pramāṇa-anugrahaka* - assumes the contradictory and exhibits an unacceptable consequence, removing the doubt that blocks *vyāptigraha*. **Sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa** answers the class-character objection by presenting the universal through the particular. Finally, **parāmarśa** - the mark cognised as qualified by concomitance - shows that no "leap" occurs at all.

ANALYSIS: **Assessment.** Nyāya succeeds on three counts. *Hypothetical reasoning (tarka)* has real bite against Cārvāka specifically, since the Cārvāka's own acting, expecting and arguing presuppose the regularities he refuses to certify. **Parāmarśa** dissolves the "leap" picture on which the objection trades. And Sharma's counter-attack reverses the hierarchy: perception errs - the flat earth, the static earth, the small solar disc - and is corrected **by inference**, while "mere sensation cannot be regarded as a means of knowledge unless conception ... has arranged into order ... the loose threads of sense-data".

ANALYSIS: Yet three concessions remain. Only **suspected upādhis** can be eliminated. *Hypothetical reasoning (tarka)* proves nothing alone. *Sāmānyalakṣaṇa* is defensible only inside Nyāya's realism about universals.

ANALYSIS: **Verdict.** Nyāya answers the Cārvāka **by changing the standard** - from omniscient certainty to disciplined rational warrant, since "the Nyāya point is not infallibilism but disciplined justificatory practice". Judged by **warrant**, Nyāya wins; judged by **entailment**, the Cārvāka's logical point survives untouched. The real disagreement is therefore about the concept of knowledge, not about the logic of induction, on which both agree.

Why this earns marks

- Both positions given their strongest form, with Sanskrit terms glossed.
- The eight-stage Nyāya construction at least summarised.
- *Hypothetical reasoning (tarka)* and *sāmānyalakṣaṇa* correctly characterised, including their limits.
- Sharma's counter-attack on perception included.
- A verdict that names **two** criteria and delivers a different result under each.